

Master Thesis

Double MSc Degree in Industrial Engineering and Energy
Engineering

Dynamic Simulation and Stability Analysis of Power Systems: Development of RMS and EMT Tools within VeraGrid at eRoots

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Abstract

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Glossary

Symbols

λ	Eigenvalue
ζ	Damping ratio
ω	Angular frequency vector
A	State matrix
B	Input matrix
C	Output matrix
D	Feedthrough matrix
x	State vector
u	Input vector
y	Output vector
τ	Time constant
V	Voltage module
θ	Voltage angle
P	Active power
Q	Reactive power
g	Conductance
b	Susceptance
K_p	Proportional gain
M	Inertia constant
D	Damping coefficient
f	System frequency
Γ	Torque
R	Resistance
X	Reactance
v_f	Field excitation voltage
e_t	Error
ψ	Electromagnetic flux
δ	Rotor electrical angle with respect to the synchronous reference
ω	Rotor angular speed

Acronyms

AC	Alternating Current
CIG	Converter-interfaced Generation
DAE	Differential Algebraic Equation
DC	Direct Current
EEA	European Environment Agency
EMT	Electro Magnetic Transient
ETSEIB	Escola Tècnica Superior d'Enginyeria Industrial de Barcelona
GUI	Guided User Interface
HVAC	Heating Ventilation and Air Conditioning
IBR	Inverter-Based Resources
ICAEN	Institut Català de l'Energia
IGE	Induction Generator Effect
LCA	Life Cycle Assessment
MNA	Modified Nodal Analysis
ODE	Ordinary Differential Equation
PF	Participation Factor
PSCAD	Power Systems Computer Aided Design
RMS	Root Mean Square
SFA	Shifted Frequency Analysis
SPT	Singular Perturbation Theory
SSCI	Subsynchronous Control Interaction
SSR	Subsynchronous Resonance
TDS	Time Domain Simulation

Preface

This thesis has been developed within the framework of the Double Master's Degree in Industrial Engineering and Energy Engineering and has been carried out in collaboration with eRoots Analytics as part of the ongoing development of the VeraGrid software platform. The work combines academic research with practical software development, addressing real engineering challenges related to the dynamic simulation and stability analysis of modern power systems.

The project is positioned at the intersection of power system theory, numerical methods, and computational implementation. It focuses on extending existing simulation capabilities by incorporating small-signal stability analysis and establishing the foundations for electromagnetic transient (EMT) simulation within a unified symbolic-numeric framework. Particular emphasis is placed on model transparency, numerical robustness, and consistency between nonlinear time-domain simulations and their linearised representations.

This thesis has been supervised by Vinícius Albernaz Lacerda and Josep Fanals i Batllori, whose guidance and technical support have been essential throughout the project. The collaborative environment at eRoots Analytics has also provided valuable insights into industrial-grade power system analysis and software development practices.

The document is intended for readers with a background in power systems and dynamic analysis, and it aims to present both the theoretical foundations and the practical implementation aspects in a clear and structured manner.

1 Introduction

1.1 Motivation

Power systems are undergoing a huge transformation driven by the increasing penetration of renewable generation, the widespread adoption of power electronic converters, and the progressive reduction of system inertia. These changes challenge many of the assumptions underlying traditional power system analysis tools, which were primarily developed for networks dominated by synchronous machines and relatively slow electromechanical dynamics. As a consequence, the accurate assessment of system stability now requires simulation frameworks capable of capturing a wide range of dynamic phenomena, from low-frequency oscillations to fast electromagnetic transients.

RMS-based dynamic simulations and small-signal stability analysis remain essential tools for understanding system behaviour around an operating point, identifying poorly damped modes, and evaluating the impact of control systems. These techniques are computationally efficient and well suited for large-scale studies, making them indispensable for planning and operational applications. However, their effectiveness depends strongly on the consistency between the nonlinear dynamic models and their linearised representations, as well as on the transparency of the modelling and linearisation process.

At the same time, EMT simulations have become increasingly relevant due to the presence of converter-interfaced generation, fast control loops, and electromagnetic interactions that cannot be represented accurately using phasor-based models. EMT tools allow the study of waveform-level phenomena, detailed device behavior, and fast transients, but they are computationally demanding and often difficult to integrate into broader system-level analyses.

In this context, there is a clear need for simulation platforms that combine numerical robustness with modelling transparency, allowing engineers and researchers to move seamlessly between nonlinear time-domain simulations and analytical stability assessments. Symbolic formulation of system equations provides a powerful foundation for such platforms, enabling automated linearisation, exact Jacobian computation, and consistent model reuse across different types of analysis.

VeraGrid has been developed with this philosophy in mind, aiming to provide an open and extensible environment for power system analysis that bridges academic research and practical engineering applications. While VeraGrid already includes a broad set of steady-state and planning tools, its dynamic simulation capabilities are an active area of development. The motivation of this thesis is to contribute to this development by extending the framework with small-signal stability analysis and by laying the foundations for EMT simulation, ensuring coherent modelling, reliable numerical behavior, and validation against established commercial

tools.

By addressing both RMS-based stability analysis and EMT dynamics within a unified framework, this work aims to support the analysis of modern power systems in a transparent and flexible way, providing tools that are suitable for research, education, and real-world engineering studies.

1.2 Objectives

This thesis is part of the ongoing development of the dynamic simulation framework within VeraGrid, with a focus on extending its capabilities towards small-signal stability analysis and the implementation of foundational electromagnetic transient (EMT) simulations. The work is carried out in the context of VeraGrid's symbolic-numeric architecture, aiming to strengthen its dynamic analysis capabilities while maintaining consistency, transparency, and numerical robustness.

The main objective is to provide VeraGrid with reliable tools for analysing the dynamic behaviour of power systems across different time scales, combining RMS-based stability analysis with waveform-level EMT modelling, and ensuring coherence between nonlinear time-domain simulations and their analytical representations.

General Objective

To develop, integrate, and validate advanced dynamic simulation and stability analysis capabilities in VeraGrid by incorporating small-signal stability analysis for RMS models and establishing the foundations for EMT simulation using a combined symbolic-numeric approach.

Specific Objectives

- To develop a small-signal stability analysis module for RMS dynamic models, including the symbolic formulation and linearisation of differential-algebraic equations at an operating point, the computation of eigenvalues, damping ratios, and participation factors, and their integration into the VeraGrid graphical user interface.
- To design and implement a foundational EMT simulation framework in the abc domain, including the numerical formulation of transmission lines, synchronous machines, and transformers, using time-domain discretisation techniques derived from classical EMTP methods.
- To extend the existing symbolic framework to support EMT formulations, enabling a consistent symbolic-numeric treatment of both RMS and EMT models, and facilitating coherent model definition, and initialization.

- To ensure consistent initialization procedures for both EMT simulations, allowing stable and physically meaningful dynamic studies starting from steady-state operating points.
- To validate the developed small-signal and EMT methodologies through benchmark studies, comparing results against established tools.

1.3 Scope

This thesis is part of the ongoing development of VeraGrid, a software platform for power system planning and simulation. The work focuses on improving dynamic simulation tools for modern grids, particularly in the context of small-signal stability and electromagnetic transient (EMT) modeling. Over a five-month period, from September 2025 to January 2026, the project aims to build essential components that support symbolic formulation, numerical validation, and integration with existing simulation environments.

The first major area of focus is the implementation of small-signal stability analysis using RMS-based state-space models. This includes the computation of eigenvalues and participation factors and symbolic reduction of system equations. Out of scope but relevant in terms of VeraGrid development, the integration of these routines into the VeraGrid graphical interface is carried out. The goal is to provide users with intuitive and accurate tools for identifying dominant modes and assessing system stability under varying conditions.

The second area involves the development of a foundational EMT solver in the abc domain. This includes modeling transmission lines and components, implementing discretization techniques such as the Dommel algorithm and implementing it together with the Symbolic-Numeric approach already used in the RMS simulations in VeraGrid. This foundational EMT solver serves as a basis for future enhancements, creating the environment for EMT studies with the basic models and numerical methods needed.

All development is conducted in Python, with an emphasis on code quality, symbolic computation, and reproducibility. Technical supervision is provided by the eRoots team, ensuring alignment with architectural standards and long-term project goals.

1.4 Structure of the document

This thesis considers all the steps involved in the development process of the RMS small-signal stability analysis and the whole EMT dynamic simulation, from the mathematical modelling to the software implementation and validation of results.

- Chapter 2 describes a general introduction to Time-domain simulations with emphasis on the already done RMS dynamic simulations in VeraGrid.

- Chapter 3 describes from the theoretical framework to the implementation and benchmarking of the small-signal stability analysis in VeraGrid.
- Chapter 4 describes the theoretical framework and implementation of the EMT simulator in VeraGrid. It includes the mathematical modelling of the main components, the numerical methods used, the software implementation and the validation of results with benchmark systems.
- Chapter 5 discusses the environmental impact of the project and the chapter 6 discusses the gender and social impact of the project. Chapter 7 presents the budget of the project while chapter 8 shows the Gantt chart with the time planning of the project.
- Finally, chapter 9 summarizes the main conclusions of the project and

1.5 State of the art

The dynamic analysis of power systems has traditionally been divided into two main approaches: RMS or phasor-based simulations, used to study low-frequency electromechanical dynamics and stability, and Electromagnetic Transient (EMT) simulations, which resolve fast electromagnetic phenomena at the waveform level. Both approaches remain essential for understanding system behavior under different types of disturbances and time scales.

Small-signal stability analysis, based on the linearisation of differential-algebraic equations around a steady-state operating point, is a well-established technique for characterizing oscillatory behavior, damping, and modal interactions in power systems. It has been extensively applied to the analysis of electromechanical modes, inter-area oscillations, and control system performance. RMS-based dynamic simulations and small-signal analysis are computationally efficient and widely used in planning and operational studies, particularly in systems dominated by synchronous machines.

Commercial tools such as DIgSILENT PowerFactory and similar environments provide robust implementations of RMS simulations and small-signal analysis. However, these tools typically rely on internally defined models and linearisation routines, offering limited transparency and flexibility when custom models or control strategies need to be analysed.

EMT simulation tools, including EMTP-type programs, focus on detailed time-domain representations of voltages and currents and are commonly used to study fast transients, converter dynamics, and electromagnetic interactions. While highly accurate, EMT simulations are computationally demanding and often less suitable for large-scale system studies or systematic stability assessments.

The increasing penetration of converter-interfaced generation has highlighted the need for sim-

ulation frameworks that provide consistent modelling across different time scales and levels of detail. Symbolic-numeric approaches have gained attention in this context, as they enable explicit equation formulation, automated linearisation, and greater consistency between non-linear simulations and analytical stability analysis.

Within this framework, the development of RMS small-signal analysis and foundational EMT capabilities inside an open and extensible platform such as VeraGrid aligns with current research and industry needs, combining numerical robustness with modelling transparency and flexibility.

1.6 Veragrid

VeraGrid is a comprehensive software platform for power system planning and simulation, developed to offer both technical accuracy and accessibility. It integrates a wide range of analytical and optimization tools, covering everything from traditional steady-state analyses to advanced planning functions that address the challenges of modern electrical grids. Its capabilities include conventional studies such as power flow, short-circuit, and contingency analyses, as well as linear and non-linear optimization modules used for operational decision-making and long-term investment assessment. Many of these functions are based on established industry standards, while others are the result of ongoing research and innovation, designed to push the boundaries of what is possible in open and high-performance grid modelling.



Figure 1.1: VeraGrid banner. *Source:* VeraGrid documentation [1].

The development of VeraGrid began in 2015 with a clear objective: to create a robust programming library supported by a user-friendly interface. This pragmatic vision led to a unique ecosystem where reliability and simplicity coexist with scientific rigour. Over the years, the platform has evolved through a combination of commercial projects, academic collaborations, and internal research initiatives, ensuring that its algorithms and methods remain both practical and forward-looking.

VeraGrid serves a wide audience. For professionals, it provides transparent, efficient, and reproducible tools that enable detailed grid analysis and operational planning. For researchers, it represents an open and validated environment capable of integrating experimental algorithms and comparing methodologies. For educators and students, it offers a pedagogical platform

that connects theoretical concepts with practical, industry-grade implementations. This versatility allows VeraGrid to act as a bridge between academia, industry, and future generations of engineers.

Beyond conventional functionalities, VeraGrid includes an extensive set of features designed for modern power systems. These include a multi-layered architecture for both usability and computational efficiency; an AC/DC generalized power flow engine that supports hybrid grids and converter-based systems; short-circuit and fault analysis modules that incorporate converter control logic; and a suite of optimal power flow, expansion planning, and investment analysis tools. The platform also integrates time-series simulation capabilities for renewable energy forecasting, storage operation, and market coupling, enabling comprehensive scenario-based studies.

Thanks to its open-core design, VeraGrid can be easily extended and interfaced with external tools, ensuring interoperability and adaptability to specific project needs. It stands not only as a software product but as a complete analytical framework that evolves alongside the energy transition, enabling engineers, researchers, and institutions to model, plan, and optimize electrical networks with transparency and scientific depth.

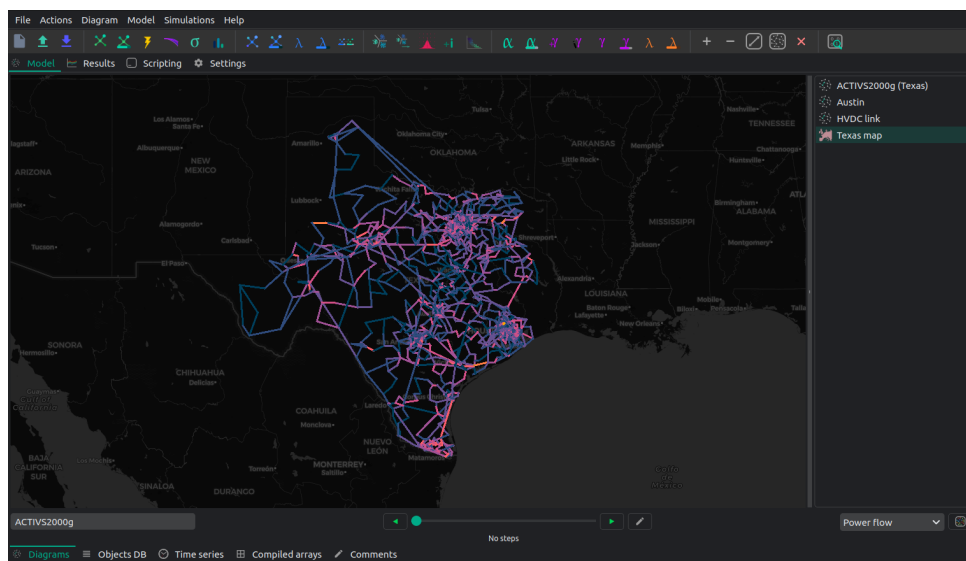


Figure 1.2: VeraGrid main page. *Source:* VeraGrid documentation [1].

2 Dynamic framework

The evolution of power systems towards greater complexity and decentralization has introduced new challenges in modeling and analyzing system dynamics. Traditional approaches, which often relied on simplifying assumptions and linear models, are increasingly inadequate for capturing the intricate behaviors exhibited by modern grids. These grids, characterized by high penetration of Inverter-Based Resources (IBRs), such as photovoltaic and wind generation, needing more detailed and accurate simulation methods to ensure reliable operation and stability [LaraTDS].

Time-domain simulations (TDS) have become a key point in the study of power system dynamics, providing a temporal perspective on system behavior following disturbances. Unlike steady-state analyses, TDS allows for the examination of transient phenomena, including voltage sags, frequency deviations, and oscillatory modes, which are critical for assessing system stability and performance. The ability to simulate the system's response over time enables engineers to design and test control strategies, protection schemes, and operational protocols in a virtual environment before implementation in the field.

A TDS requires the specification of two parts: the model of the system which must include the differential equations that describe the system and the integration algorithm to be used to solve those equations over time [LaraTDS].

The system model is a set of dynamic equations that represent and interconnect the components of a system expressed with differential equations. Those equations are divided between the device equations that store the state of the system and the circuit dynamics of the network. Depending on the type of simulation to be performed, the model of the system can have many different forms, mainly influenced by simplifications and transformations of the system equations and variables. A general explanation of the main methods to simplify and transform systems based on [LaraTDS] are listed below.

- *Averaging dynamics*: These simplifying methods replace fast dynamics of complicated time-varying variables with their average value. An example is setting the system's frequency to its averaged value or replacing discontinuous switching in a converter with its average behavior. Three main methods are distinguished:
 - *Steady-state phasors*: Commonly used in engineering using the wave's root-mean-square value instead of the instantaneous value. It requires stationary conditions and homogeneous frequency.
 - *Dynamic phasors*: Used to describe the behavior of time-varying periodic signals, particularly under conditions where the system frequency or amplitude may vary

slowly compared to the fundamental period. These capture both the slowly-varying average and instantaneous phase of the signal. Three different approaches are considered (Fourier approach, time-varying phasors, and Shifted Frequency Analysis (SFA) based), but all of them must ensure that the integral of the signal over the studied period is well-defined and that the signal is band-limited for a given frequency.

- *Three-Phase signals & models*: For three-phase systems, SFA is applied phase by phase to a three-phase abc representation to study unbalanced systems. Using the Fortescue transform [**Fortescue**], multi-phase quantities (voltages, currents, electromagnetic fluxes, and impedances) with a common system frequency w_s and offset θ are represented in a two-dimensional vector dividing the positive and negative-frequency. It should be noted that in balanced systems, the signal phasor is completely determined by the positive-sequence phasor.
- *Reference frame transformations*: Such as the Park Transform (or $dq0$ transform), which allow the representation of time-variant signals as quasi-static ones, simplifying its analysis.
- *Singular Perturbation Theory (SPT)*: Used to analyze dynamic systems with widely separated time scales by decomposing them into fast and slow subsystems. In power systems, SPT is applied to separate the fast transients of synchronous machines and converters (milliseconds) from the slow dynamics of controllers and system frequency (seconds to minutes), enabling more efficient RMS simulations and small-signal analyses.

In power systems, time-domain simulations can generally be divided into two main categories [**LaraTDS**].

The first category, *Quasi-Static Phasor (QSP) simulations*, models the transmission network dynamics in an algebraic manner by considering discrete transitions between successive steady-state operating points, in other words, QSP focus on dynamics that do not deviate much from steady-state frequency. These simulations are primarily used to analyze low-frequency phenomena, such as inertial responses and frequency regulation. Many different options are exposed for QSP:

- *RMS balanced or Positive sequence*: The system is modeled using a single phase, the positive sequence. The models are formulated as DAEs of the general form. These types of simulators are primarily designed for the analysis of machine angles in balanced transmission systems.
- *RMS unbalanced*: These simulations are applied to networks with asymmetrical configurations. The three sequence networks are simplified according to the type of fault being analyzed. Such models are typically used to assess the system's transient response both

during and after unbalanced fault events.

- *RMS Dynamic Phasors*: This approach models the network using Fourier dynamic phasors, representing each harmonic component with a subset of differential-algebraic equations. In most RMS applications, the derivative terms of the network are neglected, as they correspond to faster dynamics than those of the connected devices. The model's accuracy depends on the number of harmonics included and on whether the dynamics around each harmonic allow this simplification.
- *dq0-Model with Algebraic Network*: This simulation approach applies a dq0 transformation and assumes steady-state conditions by neglecting the derivative terms of the network. In balanced systems, it is equivalent to the positive-sequence model. For asymmetric networks or when including harmonics, the method can require larger integration steps, and its usefulness is limited due to the resulting time-varying behavior.

The second category, *Electromagnetic Transient (EMT) simulations*. These models incorporate detailed system dynamics to capture fast transient phenomena and deviations from steady-state conditions. They are commonly used to study high-frequency events such as transmission line dynamics, converter switching, machine flux behavior, overvoltages, harmonic propagation, sub-synchronous resonance, transient recovery voltages, and external disturbances like lightning surges. A variety of modeling and computational techniques are employed to balance accuracy with the computational cost of these simulations. Many different options are exposed for EMT:

- *Waveform or abc-simulations*: They represent the full voltage and current waveforms throughout the simulation, producing a fully time-varying system. Waveform simulations require careful initialization and selection of integration techniques, and typically employ detailed transmission line models, such as Bergeron or frequency-dependent representations, to capture fast electromagnetic phenomena.
- *dq0-model*: This approach models the network in a rotating reference frame using a transformed π -model. In balanced systems, the model produces a time-invariant formulation and shares the same initialization routine as the positive-sequence RMS model. Since the network is represented using only ODEs, the system becomes a set of stiff differential equations due to the multi-rate dynamics, often needing simultaneous-implicit solution methods. However, the advantages of this formulation diminish in unbalanced networks or when harmonics are included, as the model then produces time-varying signals similar to full waveform simulations.
- *Dynamic Phasors*: This method models power system transients using dynamic phasors, ideal for narrow-band signals around harmonic frequencies. It can produce time-invariant

models with additional states or time-variant models for advanced analyses like small-signal sensitivity studies. The approach improves computational efficiency when reducing bandwidth, it outweighs the cost of extra states.

In this thesis, and within the context of the VeraGrid project, the simulations primarily rely on RMS balanced models, which are already implemented in VeraGrid. Additionally, EMT waveform or *abc* domain simulations will be developed as a foundational part of this work.

2.1 Differential-Algebraic Equations (DAEs)

At the core of Time-domain simulations lie the mathematical models that describe the system's dynamics. These models are typically formulated as Differential-Algebraic Equations (DAEs), which combine differential equations that represent the system's dynamic behavior with algebraic equations that describe instantaneous relationships between system variables. In contrast, Ordinary Differential Equations (ODEs) are used to model systems where all variables change continuously over time without algebraic constraints. The choice between DAEs and ODEs depends on the specific characteristics of the system being modeled and the phenomena of interest.

In many dynamic systems, including power systems, their model is not only composed of purely differential equations but also algebraic constraints linking the state variables. Such systems are naturally represented by differential-algebraic equations (DAEs). Formally, a DAE is an equation of the form:

$$F(\dot{x}(t), x(t), y(t), t) = 0 \quad (2.1)$$

Where $x(t) \in \mathbb{R}^n$ are the differential variables, $y(t) \in \mathbb{R}^m$ are algebraic variables, and the function F encodes both the differential and algebraic relations. In contrast to an ordinary differential equation (ODE), not all derivatives $\dot{x}$ can be explicitly solved from the system because some variables appear only algebraically, that is, without derivative [CasellaDAE].

One common formulation is the so-called semi-explicit DAE:

$$\begin{cases} \dot{x} = f(x, y, t) \\ 0 = g(x, y, t) \end{cases} \quad (2.2)$$

Where $f: \mathbb{R}^{n+m+1} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^n$ and $g: \mathbb{R}^{n+m+1} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^m$. In this form, one treats some variables x as dynamic and others y as constrained by algebraic equations. The condition to solve the DAE is that the partial jacobian $\partial g / \partial y$ is nonsingular so that y can be locally solved as a function of x and t [CasellaDAE]. If the partial jacobian is singular an iterative process must be done re-casting the problem until it is possible to solve.

An alternative is the fully implicit form:

$$f(\dot{x}, x, y, t) = 0 \quad (2.3)$$

With no explicit separation of differential and algebraic parts. In that representation, one works directly with the combined vector $(\dot{x}, x, y)$ and the solver must treat the singularity in $\partial f / \partial \dot{x}$. Implicit DAEs are more general and often arise in multiphysics problems and constrained mechanical systems [**CasellaDAE**].

In power system dynamics, the network and algebraic constraints (Kirchhoff's current law, network admittance equations, etc.) naturally provide algebraic equations, while generator rotor dynamics, excitation systems, governor control, and other dynamic devices supply the differential equations. Thus a typical formulation is:

$$\begin{cases} \dot{x} = f(x, y) \\ 0 = g(x, y) \end{cases} \quad (2.4)$$

Where x includes rotor angles, speed deviations, internal voltages, control states, and y includes bus voltages, phase angles, algebraic currents, and so on [**SauerPaiBook**]. The coupling is strong: every time step, the algebraic network equations must be solved together with the differential updates, typically via Newton-Raphson or other Newton-based solvers applied to the full system jacobian.

This DAE-based representation ensures that the physical constraints of the network are never violated, and that stability and modal analysis reflect the full coupled system behavior, rather than an oversimplified reduced ODE form.

2.2 Symbolic framework

The development of modern power system simulation tools has progressively incorporated symbolic computation to enhance both the analytical transparency and numerical robustness of dynamic models. A symbolic framework refers to an environment in which the mathematical equations describing a physical system are manipulated symbolically before numerical evaluation. This approach enables the explicit representation of the differential and algebraic equations governing power system dynamics, allowing the automatic derivation of jacobians and linearized models directly from the symbolic expressions. Such symbolic processing bridges the gap between manual analytical formulation and automated numerical computation, ensuring consistency and reproducibility across different analysis tasks [2].

In general, a symbolic modeling framework treats system equations as algebraic entities rather than arrays of numbers. Each state variable, parameter, and equation is represented symbolically and stored in structured form. Once the symbolic system is constructed, operations such as differentiation, substitution, and matrix assembly can be performed analytically. These expressions can then be compiled into efficient numerical routines to be executed by solvers. This two-step process, symbolic formulation followed by numerical evaluation, provides the flexibility to modify models, perform analytical checks and generate adapted code for various simulation modes without redefining the mathematical structure.

Power systems are naturally suited to this formulation, as their behavior is described by a set of coupled DAEs representing both dynamic components and network constraints. In this context, generators, exciters, governors, and control systems contribute to differential equations, whereas network variables, bus voltages, currents, and algebraic constraints from Kirchhoff's laws; are represented algebraically. By expressing these components symbolically, they can be automatically assembled into a unified system model and linearized analytically to obtain small-signal representations. This methodology ensures that the global model preserves physical consistency and that linearization results, such as eigenvalues and participation factors, are computed with exact analytical derivatives rather than numerical approximations.

It should be noted that the DAEs representing each element and device in the network can be simplified or extended depending on the desired level of modelling accuracy. A trade-off must therefore be established between computational complexity and numerical accuracy. In practical applications, simplified formulations are often used for large-scale steady-state or RMS simulations, whereas more detailed dynamic representations are required for transient and small-signal stability studies. The flexibility of the symbolic framework allows the modeller to adapt the formulation of each component accordingly, preserving analytical consistency while optimizing computational performance.

2.3 RMS simulations in VeraGrid

In the context of VeraGrid, time-domain simulations have been implemented to model the dynamic behavior of power systems. The framework supports balanced Root Mean Square (RMS) simulations, which are suitable for analyzing low-frequency dynamics in systems dominated by synchronous machines. The implementation includes:

- *Symbolic framework*: A new set of classes is created in order to be able to operate in the symbolic framework.
- *Models*: Detailed representations of system components, including generators, loads, and transmission lines, are developed to capture their dynamic responses accurately.

- *Solver*: The implicit Euler integration method is employed to solve the system's DAEs, ensuring stable and accurate simulation results.
- *Initialization*: Procedures are established to determine the steady-state operating point of the system before introducing disturbances, providing a consistent starting point for dynamic simulations.

This subsection acts as a summary of the already done work on RMS simulations in Veragrid.

2.3.1 Symbolic framework

To implement the symbolic formulation in practice, VeraGrid defines a minimal hierarchy of classes that abstract mathematical entities such as variables, constants, and operators. The main classes are stated below.

- *Expr*: Expression is an abstract class that can be used as any expression for a node. Depending of it's nature it can work as many different objects.
- *Var*: Variables are stored as their name (string) and their value set as Number (integer, float or complex number) or *Expr*. This allows values stored in *Var* to be able to change. Some of the variables can be assigned as *Dynamic variable* which means those variables are part of an other device but are also used in the DAEs of the device created.
- *Const*: Constants are stored as their name (string) and their value set as Number (integer, float or complex number). Those are frozen parameters of the grid.
- *BinOp*: Binary operator stores each possibility of binary operation. The following arithmetic operations are defined: addition, subtraction, multiplication, division and exponentiation.
- *Func*: Functions store each individual function possible that can be part of an equation: sinus, cosinus, tangent, logarithm, real or imaginary parts among others.

All these elements are unified to create *Blocks*, a set of differential and algebraic equations and stated variables that form the symbolic representation of the DAEs of each element. Blocks also include a set of initializing variables and equations and fixed variables and equations that help initialize the DAEs and allow a fastest solution. All variables in a Block are stored as children of that Block in order to allow recursivity. This recursive structure means that each block can contain child elements (either variables or other blocks) allowing a hierarchical representation of the power system. Such a design enables complex devices and networks to be constructed from smaller symbolic components while maintaining full analytical traceability. Moreover, parameters are also defined as the variables or constants affected by events that can be added

to the grid.

2.3.2 RMS models

VeraGrid's version of the symbolic framework includes three different types of elements in the grid: buses, injections and branches. Injections include all types of elements that contribute actively to the system: generators, loads, batteries, shunts... Branches include the devices that connect buses: lines, transformers, converters...

In this subsection, the RMS models of the grid elements in VeraGrid are exposed.

Injections

- **Static load** The model for the static load is quite simple since P and Q are meant to be constant. Therefore, the algebraic equations corresponding to the load are only initializing the power to its value.

$$\begin{cases} P_l - P_{l,0} = 0 \\ Q_l - Q_{l,0} = 0 \end{cases} \quad (2.5)$$

Where:

- P_l : (Algebraic variable) Active power consumed by the load [MW].
- Q_l : (Algebraic variable) Reactive power consumed by the load [Mvar].
- $P_{l,0}$: (Algebraic variable) Active power consumed by the load at time 0 [MW].
- $Q_{l,0}$: (Algebraic variable) Reactive power consumed by the load at time 0 [Mvar].
- **Shunt** For the shunt, the algebraic equations are also simple. They define the formula for the active and reactive power.

$$\begin{cases} P_{sh} - gV^2 = 0 \\ P_{sh} - bV^2 = 0 \end{cases} \quad (2.6)$$

Where:

- P_{sh} : (Algebraic variable) Active power injected or absorbed by the shunt [MW].
- Q_{sh} : (Algebraic variable) Reactive power injected or absorbed by the shunt [Mvar].
- g : (Constant parameter) Shunt conductance [p.u.].

- b : (Constant parameter) Shunt susceptance [p.u.].
- V : (Constant parameter) Shunt voltage [p.u.].
- **Synchronous generator** The synchronous generator is defined by a set of differential(or state) and algebraic equations.

$$\begin{cases} \frac{d\delta}{dt} = 2\pi f (\omega - \omega_{\text{ref}}) \\ \frac{d\omega}{dt} = \frac{\Gamma_m - \Gamma_e - D(\omega - \omega_{\text{ref}})}{M} \end{cases} \quad (2.7)$$

With $\frac{d\delta}{dt}$ and $\frac{d\omega}{dt}$ set to zero since steady state conditions are considered in RMS simulations.

$$\begin{cases} \psi_d - (R \cdot i_q + v_q) = 0 \\ \psi_q + (R \cdot i_d + v_d) = 0 \\ 0 - (\psi_d + X \cdot i_d - v_f) = 0 \\ 0 - (\psi_q + X \cdot i_q) = 0 \\ v_d - (V \cdot \sin(\delta - \theta)) = 0 \\ v_q - (V \cdot \cos(\delta - \theta)) = 0 \\ \Gamma_e - (\psi_d \cdot i_q - \psi_q \cdot i_d) = 0 \\ P_g - (v_d \cdot i_d + v_q \cdot i_q) = 0 \\ Q_g - (v_q \cdot i_d - v_d \cdot i_q) = 0 \\ \Gamma_m - (\Gamma_{m0} + K_p(\omega - \omega_{\text{ref}}) + K_i \cdot e_t) = 0 \\ 2\pi f \cdot e_t - \delta = 0 \end{cases} \quad (2.8)$$

Where:

- δ : (State variable) Rotor electrical angle with respect to the synchronous reference frame [rad].
- ω : (State variable) Rotor angular speed [rad/s].
- P_g : (Algebraic variable) Active electrical power delivered by the generator [MW].
- Q_g : (Algebraic variable) Reactive electrical power delivered by the generator [Mvar].
- v_d : (Algebraic variable) d-axis stator voltage component in Park reference frame [p.u.].

- v_q : (Algebraic variable) q-axis stator voltage component in Park reference frame [p.u.].
- i_d : (Algebraic variable) d-axis stator current component in Park reference frame [p.u.].
- i_q : (Algebraic variable) q-axis stator current component in Park reference frame [p.u.].
- ψ_d : (Algebraic variable) d-axis stator flux linkage in Park reference frame [p.u.].
- ψ_q : (Algebraic variable) q-axis stator flux linkage in Park reference frame [p.u.].
- Γ_e : (Algebraic variable) Electromagnetic torque produced by the generator [p.u.].
- Γ_m : (Algebraic variable) Mechanical torque applied to the rotor [p.u.].
- e_t : (Algebraic variable) Integral term of the governor controller, representing the accumulated speed error [rad/s].
- V : (Algebraic variable from the bus) Magnitude of the terminal voltage phasor [p.u.].
- θ : (Algebraic variable from the bus) Angle of the terminal voltage phasor with respect to the reference frame [rad].
- $\Gamma_{m,0}$: (Fixed variable) Initial mechanical torque reference [p.u.].
- f : (Constant parameter) Nominal electrical frequency [Hz].
- D : (Constant parameter) Damping coefficient representing mechanical damping effects [p.u.].
- M : (Constant parameter) Inertia constant of the rotor [p.u.s].
- R : (Constant parameter) Stator winding resistance [p.u.].
- X : (Constant parameter) Stator synchronous reactance [p.u.].
- v_f : (Constant parameter) Field excitation voltage [p.u.].
- K_p : (Constant parameter) Proportional gain of the speed governor control [-].
- K_i : (Constant parameter) Integral gain of the speed governor control [-].

Branches

- **Line** The line algebraic equations are the active and reactive power equations corresponding to the π model of lines. In this case, the RMS model for the lines is also valid for the transformers.

$$\begin{cases} P_f = V_f^2 g - g V_f V_t \cos(\theta_f - \theta_t) + b V_f V_t \cos\left(\theta_f - \theta_t + \frac{\pi}{2}\right) \\ Q_f = V_f^2 \left(-\frac{b_{sh}}{2} - b\right) - g V_f V_t \sin(\theta_f - \theta_t) + b V_f V_t \sin\left(\theta_f - \theta_t + \frac{\pi}{2}\right) \\ P_t = V_t^2 g - g V_t V_f \cos(\theta_t - \theta_f) + b V_t V_f \cos\left(\theta_t - \theta_f + \frac{\pi}{2}\right) \\ Q_t = V_t^2 \left(-\frac{b_{sh}}{2} - b\right) - g V_t V_f \sin(\theta_t - \theta_f) + b V_t V_f \sin\left(\theta_t - \theta_f + \frac{\pi}{2}\right) \end{cases} \quad (2.9)$$

Where:

- P_f : (Algebraic variable) Active power at the beginning of the line (at the bus defined as beginning) [MW].
- Q_f : (Algebraic variable) Reactive power at the beginning of the line (at the bus defined as beginning) [Mvar].
- P_t : (Algebraic variable) Active power at the end of the line (at the bus defined as end) [MW].
- Q_t : (Algebraic variable) Reactive power at the end of the line (at the bus defined as end) [Mvar].
- V_f : (Algebraic variable) Voltage magnitude at the beginning of the line (at the bus defined as beginning) [p.u.].
- V_t : (Algebraic variable) Voltage magnitude at the end of the line (at the bus defined as end) [p.u.].
- θ_f : (Algebraic variable) Voltage angle at the beginning of the line (at the bus defined as beginning) [rad].
- θ_t : (Algebraic variable) Voltage angle at the end of the line (at the bus defined as end) [rad].
- g : (Constant parameter) Line conductance [p.u.].
- b : (Constant parameter) Line susceptance [p.u.].
- b_{sh} : (Constant parameter) Shunt susceptance [p.u.].

Bus The buses store the conservation equations itself. Those are algebraic equations in 2.10. For example in a bus where a generator is connected, the power that the generator delivers to the bus must be the same as the power in the line connected to the bus. However, the variables associated to the bus are the voltage magnitude V and angle θ . All the variables in the bus algebraic equations are defined as *dynamic variables* since they also appear on other devices (such as the generators or lines connected to the bus) so those must be able to be callable from all the device's blocks.

$$\begin{cases} \sum_i P_{\text{inj}} + \sum_i P_{\text{branch}} = 0 \\ \sum_i Q_{\text{inj}} + \sum_i Q_{\text{branch}} = 0 \end{cases} \quad (2.10)$$

Where:

- P_{inj} : (Algebraic variable) Active power from injections. If the injections are generators the power will be positive and if they are loads, it will be negative [MW].
- Q_{inj} : (Algebraic variable) Reactive power from injections. If the injections are generators the power will be positive and if they are loads, it will be negative [Mvar].
- P_{branch} : (Algebraic variable) Active power that is transported from or to the line connected to the bus [MW].
- Q_{branch} : (Algebraic variable) Reactive power that is transported from or to the line connected to the bus [Mvar].

2.3.3 Integration method: Implicit Euler

In the numerical integration of differential or differential-algebraic equations (DAEs), Euler methods represent one of the most fundamental approaches for approximating the time evolution of system variables. They discretize the continuous time domain into a series of steps of size h , and approximate the derivative using finite differences. In RMS power system simulations, which combine slow electromechanical dynamics with algebraic network equations, Euler methods are often used to understand the basic principles of time integration before moving to more advanced schemes [Butcher2008].

The explicit, or forward, Euler method estimates the derivative at the current time step t_i and updates the state variable y according to:

$$y_{i+1} = y_i + h \left. \frac{\delta y}{\delta t} \right|_{t_i, y_i} \quad (2.11)$$

This simple expression is obtained by integrating the differential equation $\dot{y} = f(t, y)$ over the

interval $[t_i, t_{i+1}]$ and approximating the derivative by its value at t_i . The method is straightforward to implement and computationally inexpensive, as the right-hand side depends only on known quantities at the current time step. However, it is conditionally stable, which means that the time step h must remain below a certain limit for the numerical solution to remain stable [Butcher2008].

For stiff systems, those in which some variables evolve much faster than others, this stability condition becomes extremely restrictive. In power system models, where fast control loops and electromagnetic effects coexist with slow mechanical dynamics, the forward Euler method becomes inefficient and may even diverge if the step size is not sufficiently small [LaraTDS].

On the contrary, the implicit, or backward, Euler method overcomes these limitations by evaluating the derivative at the next time step t_{i+1} :

$$y_{i+1} = y_i + h \left. \frac{\delta y}{\delta t} \right|_{t_{i+1}, y_{i+1}} \quad (2.12)$$

This can alternatively be expressed as:

$$y_i = y_{i+1} - h \left. \frac{\delta y}{\delta t} \right|_{t_{i+1}, y_{i+1}} \quad (2.13)$$

Since the derivative depends on the unknown future value y_{i+1} , this approach is called implicit. Solving for y_{i+1} requires finding the root of a nonlinear equation, which is typically done using an iterative method such as Newton-Raphson [Hindmarsh1995]. Although this increases the computational cost per time step, the backward Euler method provides unconditional stability for linear systems and is therefore well-suited for stiff problems [Butcher2008].

Intuitively, the method tends to damp fast transients, which makes it ideal for systems dominated by both fast and slow dynamics, as in power systems. Its numerical damping helps maintain stability even with relatively large time steps, although at the expense of reduced accuracy, since the method is only first order.

Applying the implicit Euler method to DAE systems:

$$\begin{cases} \frac{x_{i+1} - x_i}{h} = f(x_{i+1}, y_{i+1}) \\ 0 = g(x_{i+1}, y_{i+1}) \end{cases} \quad (2.14)$$

which forms a set of nonlinear algebraic equations in the unknowns (x_{i+1}, y_{i+1}) . This system is solved iteratively at each time step using Newton-Raphson, requiring the evaluation of the Jacobian matrix that couples the differential and algebraic components [Hindmarsh1995].

Despite its simplicity and low order of accuracy, the backward Euler method remains one of the most robust integration schemes for stiff power system DAEs. Its unconditional stability makes it particularly suitable for RMS simulations involving large time constants or strong coupling between network and control equations [LaraTDS].

2.3.4 Initialization

The initialization of the DAEs' variables and equations done in order to start the RMS dynamic simulation is done considering two main points: the power flow results are used as variables' values and the DAE is written in the semi-explicit form. The following lines explain how the equations and variables from all the elements of the system are collected and the initial value of the variables is computed.

1. *Initialize buses*: assign bus variables and equations stored in the general bus model to each bus in the system. Since the bus equations (conservation equations) dependent mainly on the branches and injections connected to the bus, the equations are now empty.
2. *Initialize branches*: assign branch variables and equations stored in the general model for each type of branch to each branch in the system. The dynamic variables (the ones that also appear on the conservation equations of the buses), P and Q are defined as dynamic variables.
3. *Initialize injections*: assign injection variables and equations stored in the general model for each type of injection to each injection in the system. The dynamic variables (the ones that also appear on the conservation equations of the buses), P and Q are defined as dynamic variables.
4. *Initialize conservation equations*: For each bus, the conservation equations are created using the dynamic variables from branches and injections.
5. *Compose system block*: Now that all the elements in the grid have their equations and variables assigned, the block is created and the system's DAE solved.
 - (a) *Initialize containers*: the empty system block and initial guess for the variables are created.
 - (b) *Add and solve bus equations*: Each bus variables and equations are added to the system block and variables are evaluated using directly the Power Flow results (P , Q , V and θ).
 - (c) *Add and solve branch equations*: Each branch variables and equations are added to the system block and variables are evaluated using directly the Power Flow results (P ,

Q , V and θ).

- (d) *Add and solve injection equations:* Each branch variables and equations are added to the system block. The variables that are part of the Power flow results (P and Q) are directly evaluated. All the other equations are solved.

3 Small-signal stability analysis

This section explains the theoretical background, implementation and benchmark for the Small-signal stability analysis using RMS models in VeraGrid.

3.1 Theoretical background

3.1.1 Power system stability

Power system stability is defined as that property of a power system that enables it to remain in a state of operating equilibrium under normal conditions and to regain an acceptable state of equilibrium after being subjected to a disturbance [3]. Other definitions state not only the state of equilibrium must be acceptable but also most system variables must be bounded so that practically the entire system remains intact[4].

Although the primary concern is the behavior of the interconnected system as a whole, the stability of individual components such as generators, motor loads, or regional subsystems; can be equally significant, particularly when localized instability does not propagate to the broader network. The system's dynamic behavior is governed by nonlinear interactions among its elements, and its response to perturbations is influenced by both the prevailing operating conditions and the specific nature of the disturbance. Stability is understood around an equilibrium point and is subject to change under small or large disturbances.

Power system stability is commonly classified depending on the physical nature of the instability, the size of the disturbance considered and the devices, processes and time span that must be considered to assess stability [4]. The combination of these factors influence the methodologies, tools and considerations used in the analysis. The main categories of power system stability are described in the following enumeration.

- *Rotor angle stability*: The ability of the interconnected synchronous machines in a power system to remain in synchronism under normal operating conditions and to regain synchronism after being subjected to a small or large disturbance [3]. A synchronous machine stays in synchronism when the electromagnetic torque exactly balances the mechanical torque from the prime mover, producing zero net accelerating torque. Stability therefore depends on the machine and its controls restoring that torque balance after a disturbance; failure to do so causes rotor acceleration or deceleration and loss of synchronism.
- *Voltage stability*: The capacity of the network to maintain acceptable voltage magnitudes at all buses during normal operation and following disturbances, such that voltages do not decrease sustainedly. Loss of this capacity manifests as progressive voltage drops and, ultimately, voltage collapse, which may force extensive load disconnection or generalized service interruption.

- *Frequency stability*: The capability of the system to preserve a near-nominal frequency following a major imbalance between generation and demand, through inertial response and secondary/tertiary control actions. Inadequate frequency stability results in sustained under-frequency or over-frequency transients that can damage equipment, trigger protective disconnections, and precipitate broader system failure.

Due to the increasing penetration of power electronics into the grid, two new categories of stability have been considered [5].

- *Converter-driven stability*: Refers to oscillatory behavior caused by control interactions in converter-interfaced generation (CIG). Fast-interaction instabilities arise from high frequency dynamics (hundreds of Hz to kHz) involving inner control loops and grid components. Slow-interaction instabilities occur at low frequencies (<10 Hz), driven by PLL and outer-loop controls, especially in weak grids. Synchronization issues and power transfer limits further compromise stability. These phenomena differ from classical generator dynamics and require tailored mitigation strategies.
- *Resonance stability*: Refers to the system's ability to withstand oscillatory energy exchange without magnifying voltage, current, or torque beyond safe limits. It includes subsynchronous resonance (SSR), which arises from interactions between series compensation and either mechanical shaft modes or electrical generator characteristics. The mechanical form leads to torsional resonance, while the electrical form (Induction Generator Effect (IGE)) can cause self-excitation. Converter controls in DFIGs can exacerbate these effects, leading to subsynchronous control interaction (SSCI). These phenomena pose risks to both mechanical integrity and electrical equipment.

Rotor angle stability is inherent of classical power systems with synchronous machines. Modern power grids, with the increasing penetration of power electronics, have introduced new dynamics and interactions that can affect rotor angle stability. Converters decrease the inertia of the system and have an effect on the electromechanical modes. However, the fundamental principles of rotor angle stability remain intact and still takes a crucial role on stability analysis of power systems.

Therefore, understanding and analyzing rotor-angle stability remains essential for ensuring the overall reliability of power systems. Insufficient or negative synchronizing torque produces a periodic, non-oscillatory transient instability that drives large rotor-angle deviations and is typically studied with time-domain numerical integration. In contrast, the absence of adequate damping torque gives rise to small-disturbance oscillatory instability.

In the context of this thesis, the focus is on rotor angle stability, particularly small-signal stability, its eigenvalue-based characterization, modal properties, and analysis methods. The following

sections describe the theoretical background and methodologies used for small-signal stability analysis in power systems.

3.1.2 Stability of a dynamic system

A dynamic system is considered stable if, when subjected to a disturbance, it returns to its original state or to a new equilibrium state without exhibiting unbounded behavior. The equilibrium points are those states where all the derivatives $\dot{x}$ are zero, meaning the system is at rest or in a steady state.

Linearity affects on the stability of a system. The stability of a linear system is independent of the input and the initial conditions. However, for a non-linear system, stability depends on the magnitude of the input and initial conditions. Depending on the region of the state-space, stability is classified into the following categories [3]:

- *Local stability*: the system is locally stable around an equilibrium point if when a small perturbation is applied, it remains around that equilibrium point. If as time increases it returns to the equilibrium point, then it is locally asymptotically stable.
- *Finite stability*: the system is finitely stable if when a perturbation of finite size is applied, it remains bounded and does not diverge to infinity.
- *Global stability*: the system is globally stable if it returns to an equilibrium point for any initial condition in the whole state-space.

Therefore, linearizing a non-linear system around an equilibrium point allows to study its local stability as if it was a linear system.

3.1.3 Small-signal stability

Small-signal stability refers to the ability of a power system to maintain synchronism when subjected to small disturbances [3], such as minor load changes or small faults. These small disturbances (typically within 1%) occur frequently in power systems and allow the linearization of non-linear system equations around a specific operating point in order to perform analysis. The resulting linear representation enables the use of standard control engineering tools to assess system stability and dynamic performance [6].

The resulting instability due to those small perturbations can have two forms: Non-oscillatory instability defined as an increase in rotor angle due to insufficient synchronizing torque and oscillatory instability, oscillations of increasing magnitude due to insufficient damping torque [3]. In practice, most of the instabilities come from insufficient damping torque. The following list summarizes the main oscillatory modes to consider:

- *Local modes*: Oscillations involving individual generators or small groups of units swinging against the rest of the system, typically localized near a generating station.
- *Inter area modes*: Low-frequency oscillations between large groups of generators in different regions, often linked by weak transmission corridors.
- *Control modes*: Oscillations arising from interactions between poorly tuned control systems such as exciters, speed governors, HVDC converters, or static var compensators.
- *Torsional modes*: Oscillations associated with the mechanical shaft system of turbine-generators, which may become unstable due to interactions with control systems or series-compensated transmission lines.

Although small-signal analysis only applies to small variations around a fixed operating point, it remains a practical and widely used method for studying power system dynamics. By linearizing the system, it allows to apply control theory tools like eigenvalue analysis and state-space modeling. This helps identify poorly damped modes and assess how the system responds to small disturbances. Despite its limitations, it is a reliable approach for early detection of potential instabilities and for designing stabilizing controls.

3.1.4 State-space representation

Small-signal stability assessment methods are generally categorized into two main groups: state-space techniques and frequency-domain techniques. State-space techniques allow one to represent the system using a set of first order differential equations written in the following form:

$$\dot{x} = f(x, u, t) \quad (3.1)$$

Where x is the state column vector that stores the state variables, u is the input column vector that stores external signals that influence the system performance and t is time. The system can also not depend on time, that system is called time-invariant. It is also important to note that state variables are the minimum amount of variables needed to represent the system and be able to compute its future behavior.

Often the purpose of the state-space representation is to look at a set of the system variables, called outputs y . Then, a new expression is added to the state-space representation:

$$y = g(x, u, t) \quad (3.2)$$

Where y is the output column vector that stores the output variables.

A dynamic system can be described in many different ways depending on which variables are

chosen as states, inputs, and outputs. These choices shape how the system behaves mathematically and how easily can it be analyzed. For example, using electrical quantities like voltage and current might be more practical for converter models, while mechanical variables such as rotor angle and speed are better suited for synchronous machines. The flexibility in selecting these variables allows to adapt the model to the specific goals of the study while still ensuring that the essential dynamics of the system are captured.

State-space models are commonly represented in their matrix formulation as follows:

$$\dot{x} = Ax + Bu \quad (3.3)$$

$$y = Cx + Du \quad (3.4)$$

Where:

- x : state variables vector
- u : system inputs vector
- y : outputs vector
- A : state matrix
- B : input matrix
- C : output matrix
- D : direct transmission matrix

Linearization of state-space models In order to linearize a non-linear state-space model, a small perturbation is applied around the operation point (equilibrium point).

$$\mathcal{X} \triangleq x - x^* \quad (3.5)$$

$$\mathcal{Y} \triangleq y - y^* \quad (3.6)$$

$$\mathcal{U} \triangleq u - u^* \quad (3.7)$$

Where x^* , y^* and u^* are the state, output and input vectors at the equilibrium point respectively. The new linearized state-space model is given by:

$$\dot{\mathcal{X}} = A\mathcal{X} + BU \quad (3.8)$$

$$\mathcal{Y} = C\mathcal{X} + DU \quad (3.9)$$

Where the new matrices are computed as the Jacobian matrices of the non linear system evaluated at the equilibrium point:

$$A = \begin{bmatrix} \frac{\partial f_1}{\partial x_1} & \dots & \frac{\partial f_1}{\partial x_n} \\ \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ \frac{\partial f_n}{\partial x_1} & \dots & \frac{\partial f_n}{\partial x_n} \end{bmatrix} \quad (3.10)$$

$$B = \begin{bmatrix} \frac{\partial f_1}{\partial u_1} & \dots & \frac{\partial f_1}{\partial u_n} \\ \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ \frac{\partial f_n}{\partial u_1} & \dots & \frac{\partial f_n}{\partial u_n} \end{bmatrix} \quad (3.11)$$

$$C = \begin{bmatrix} \frac{\partial g_1}{\partial x_1} & \dots & \frac{\partial g_1}{\partial x_n} \\ \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ \frac{\partial g_n}{\partial x_1} & \dots & \frac{\partial g_n}{\partial x_n} \end{bmatrix} \quad (3.12)$$

$$D = \begin{bmatrix} \frac{\partial g_1}{\partial u_1} & \dots & \frac{\partial g_1}{\partial u_n} \\ \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ \frac{\partial g_n}{\partial u_1} & \dots & \frac{\partial g_n}{\partial u_n} \end{bmatrix} \quad (3.13)$$

For simplicity, the perturbation notation is often omitted, and the linearized state-space model is expressed as:

$$\Delta \dot{x} = A\Delta x + B\Delta u \quad (3.14)$$

$$\Delta y = C\Delta x + D\Delta u \quad (3.15)$$

3.1.5 DAE to state-space representation

In power systems, the dynamic behavior is mathematically represented by a set of Differential-Algebraic Equations (DAEs) that capture the interaction between dynamic components and network constraints. This formulation naturally arises because power systems combine elements with both dynamic and instantaneous responses.

The explicit formulation of the DAE system is given by:

$$T\dot{x} = f(x, y) \quad (3.16)$$

$$0 = g(x, y) \quad (3.17)$$

Which is linearized around an equilibrium point as follows:

$$T\Delta \dot{x} = \frac{\delta f}{\delta x} \Delta x + \frac{\delta f}{\delta y} \Delta y \quad (3.18)$$

$$0 = \frac{\delta g}{\delta x} \Delta x + \frac{\delta g}{\delta y} \Delta y \quad (3.19)$$

From the second equation, Δy can be expressed in terms of Δx :

$$g_y \Delta y = -g_x \Delta x \rightarrow \Delta y = -g_y^{-1} g_x \Delta x \quad (3.20)$$

And then substituted into the first equation:

$$T \Delta \dot{x} = f_x \Delta x + f_y (-g_y^{-1} g_x \Delta x) \quad (3.21)$$

Rearranging the equation gives the linearized state-space representation and the expression for the state matrix A :

$$\Delta \dot{x} = T^{-1} (f_x - f_y g_y^{-1} g_x) \Delta x \rightarrow A = T^{-1} (f_x - f_y g_y^{-1} g_x) \quad (3.22)$$

The A matrix encapsulates the dynamic interactions between the system's state variables, accounting for both the intrinsic dynamics of the components and the constraints imposed by the network. From the state matrix the stability assessment can be performed as explained in the next section.

3.1.6 Stability assessment: Liapunov's first method

The stability of a system can be studied in large-signal and small-signal terms. Stability *in the large* needs to study the whole non-linear system. This method is complex and requires a high computational effort. On the other hand, stability *in the small* studies the system behavior around an equilibrium point. This method is simpler and less computationally intensive, but it only provides information about the local stability of the system [3]. Computing the eigenvalues of the state matrix A allows to determine the small-signal stability of the system.

Eigenvalue analysis and participation factors (PF) are key tools for identifying dominant modes and evaluating system stability. These methods are well established in conventional power systems and are increasingly being applied to power-electronics-based systems, where dynamic behavior is often more complex and sensitive to operating conditions.

The eigenvalues λ of the state matrix A , commonly referred to as the system's modes, characterize its small-signal stability according to the following criteria:

- All modes satisfy $Re(\lambda) < 0$: the system is asymptotically stable
- All modes satisfy $Re(\lambda) \leq 0$: the system is marginally stable
- At least one mode satisfies $Re(\lambda) > 0$: the system is unstable

In this way, for the stable poles, the real part defines the time constant as $\tau = -1/Re(\lambda)$ [s] which represents the time that passes until the 63,2% of the steady state value is achieved, said in other words, the time that passes for the oscillations to decay to a 37% of their amplitude.

When a linearized system has complex conjugate modes, they represent oscillatory modes in the dynamic response:

- The real part determines damping:
 - $Re(\lambda) < 0$: exponential decay
 - $Re(\lambda) = 0$: oscillations persist indefinitely
 - $Re(\lambda) > 0$: exponential growth
- The imaginary part determines the oscillation frequency defined as: $f = \frac{Im(\lambda)}{2\pi}$

An other way to look at the damping of a mode is through the damping ratio ζ . The damping ratio is a dimensionless measure that describes how oscillations in a system decay after a disturbance. It is defined as the ratio of actual damping to critical damping. The critical damping is the minimum amount of damping that prevents oscillations. The damping ratio is given by:

$$\zeta = -\frac{Re(\lambda)}{\sqrt{Re(\lambda)^2 + Im(\lambda)^2}} \quad (3.23)$$

Where $Re(\lambda)$ is the real part of the eigenvalue and $Im(\lambda)$ is the imaginary part of the eigenvalue. The interpretation of the damping ratio is described below.

- $\zeta < 0$: *Unstable oscillations*. The system exhibits modes that grow exponentially with time, caused by eigenvalues located in the right half of the complex plane.
- $\zeta = 0$: *Marginal stability*. The system produces undamped, sustained oscillations since the eigenvalues lie exactly on the imaginary axis.
- $0 < \zeta < 1$: *Stable oscillatory response*. The system returns to its equilibrium point through oscillations that gradually decay over time. In practical terms, a damping ratio of about $\zeta = 0.05$ is generally considered a threshold for well-damped behavior.
- $\zeta = 1$: *Critical damping*. The system returns to equilibrium without oscillations, reaching the steady state in the shortest possible time without overshoot.

Finally, participation factors quantify the relative influence of each state variable on the different dynamic modes of the system. In essence, they indicate how much a given state contributes to a

specific mode and, conversely, how strongly that mode affects the state. This dual interpretation makes participation factors a valuable tool for understanding the internal structure of system dynamics [7].

In the context of power systems, participation factors play a key role in identifying the physical origin of oscillations and instabilities. By analyzing these factors, it is possible to determine which components—such as generators, controllers, or converter units—are most involved in poorly damped or unstable modes. This information supports targeted actions for control tuning, model validation, and stability improvement. Participation factors are calculated as follows:

$$PF_{i,k} = W_{i,k} \cdot V_{i,k} \quad (3.24)$$

Where:

- $PF_{i,k}$ is the participation factor of the k -th state variable to the i -th mode.
- $W_{i,k}$ is the left eigenvector of the k -th state variable to the i -th mode of matrix A . It satisfies $w^T A = \lambda w^T$.
- $V_{i,k}$ is the right eigenvector of the k -th state variable to the i -th mode of matrix A . It satisfies $Av = \lambda v$.

The graphical representation of the eigenvalues in the complex plane, provides a visual tool for assessing system stability. Then, it is possible to identify the stability of the system and the oscillation of the modes at a glance. An example of an eigenvalue plot is shown in Figure 3.1.

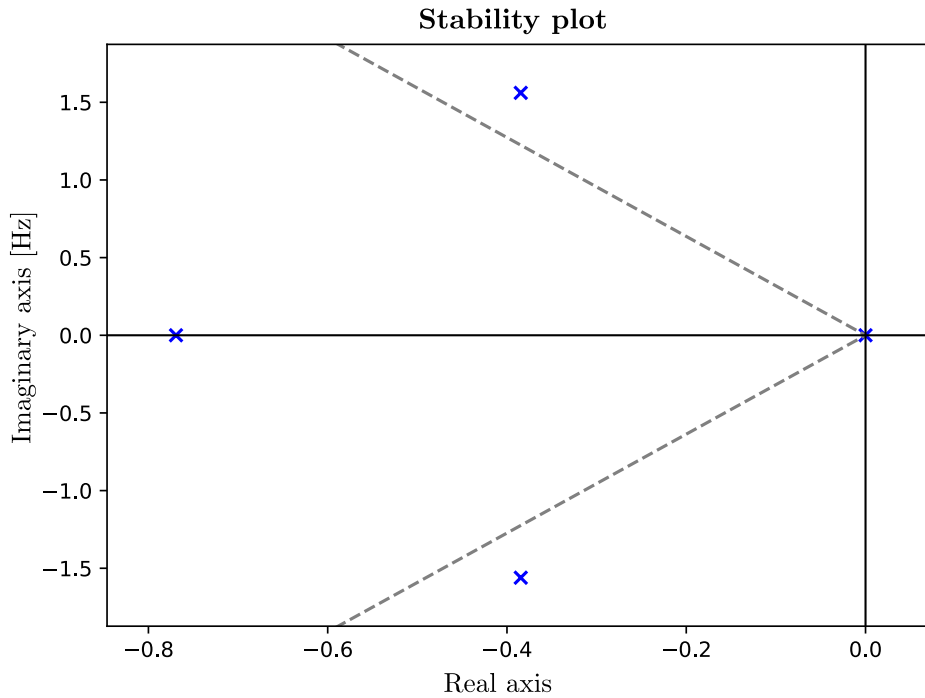


Figure 3.1: Eigenvalue plot example.

The imaginary axis divide the stable part (negative real part) from the unstable part (positive real part). Therefore, all the eigenvalues represented in the Figure are stable except for one which is in the origin, therefore the system is marginally stable. Moreover, modes outside the real axis represent oscillatory modes. In this case, one can see that there are two complex conjugate eigenvalues are represented, which means that the system has an oscillatory mode. the mode in the real axis is a non-oscillatory mode. Since it is the one with the highest real part, it is the dominant mode of the system.

3.2 Implementation

The implementation of the small-signal stability analysis is divided mainly into two parts: the code development and the GUI implementation. Strictly speaking, only the code development is part of this project. However, the GUI implementation was also carried out to provide a complete and user-friendly tool for performing small-signal stability analysis in the context of VeraGrid development as part of eRoots Analytics' main development objectives. Since the GUI implementation gives added value to the code development, it is also explained in this section.

3.2.1 Code development

The small-signal stability analysis is implemented in Python, following the general structure of the dynamic simulation framework in Veragrid. The general simulation structure for any

simulation in VeraGrid is shown in Figure 3.2.

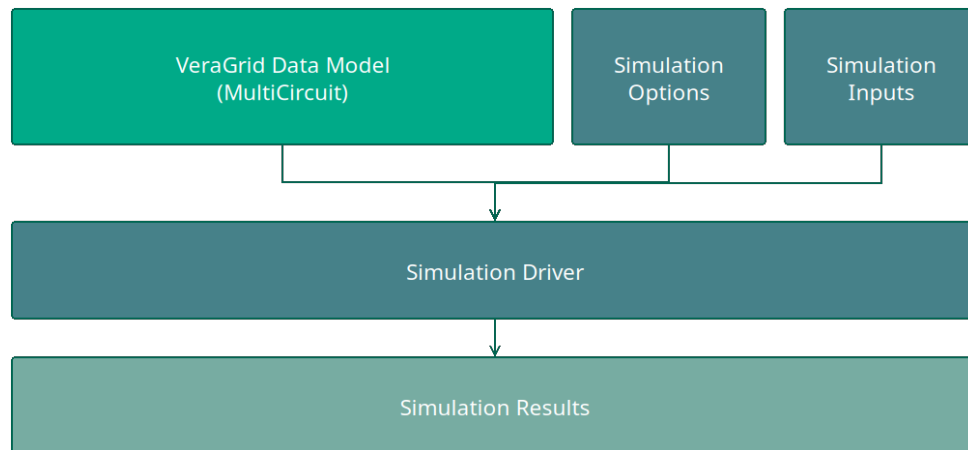


Figure 3.2: General simulation structure. *Source:* VeraGrid documentation [1].

Therefore, each simulation has three main classes explained below:

- **Driver:** This class is responsible for running the simulation. It contains the simulation analysis function itself that computes the results and the run function that is called from the GUI, and it is responsible for executing the simulation.

The block diagram of the small-signal stability analysis simulation function is shown in Figure 3.4. It consists on the A matrix computation from the jacobian matrix, the eigenvalues computation and then 2 main postprocesses: the participation factors computation and the damping ratios and oscillation frequencies computation.

The full simulation block diagram is shown in Figure 3.3 where one can see the main steps of the simulation from importing the system data to the final results. The approach given is to give the user the option to run the small-signal stability analysis whenever he/she wants in the dynamic simulation. The user can initialize the system, check the stability in the first operation point, add an event and then check the stability again in the new operation point just choosing the assessment time.

- **Results:** This class is responsible for storing the results of the simulation. It contains the data structure that holds the results and the way they are accessed from the GUI. In this case, the results class show three main results: the eigenvalues with their corresponding damping ratios and oscillation frequencies, the participation factors matrix with the corresponding eigenvalues and states for each column and row respectively, and the complex plane plot of the eigenvalues in bot rad/s and Hz for the imaginary axis.
- **Options:** This class is responsible for defining the options of the simulation. It contains

the parameters that can be set by the user from the GUI. In this case, the options class allows the user to set the assessment time, and in case the dynamic simulation is needed, the options for the simulation: integration method, time step and tolerance.

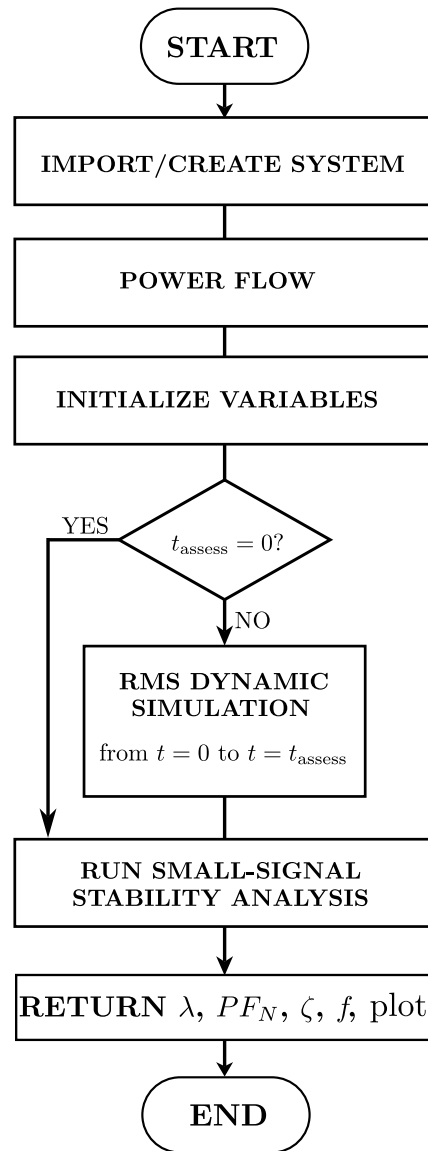


Figure 3.3: Small-signal stability analysis full simulation block diagram.

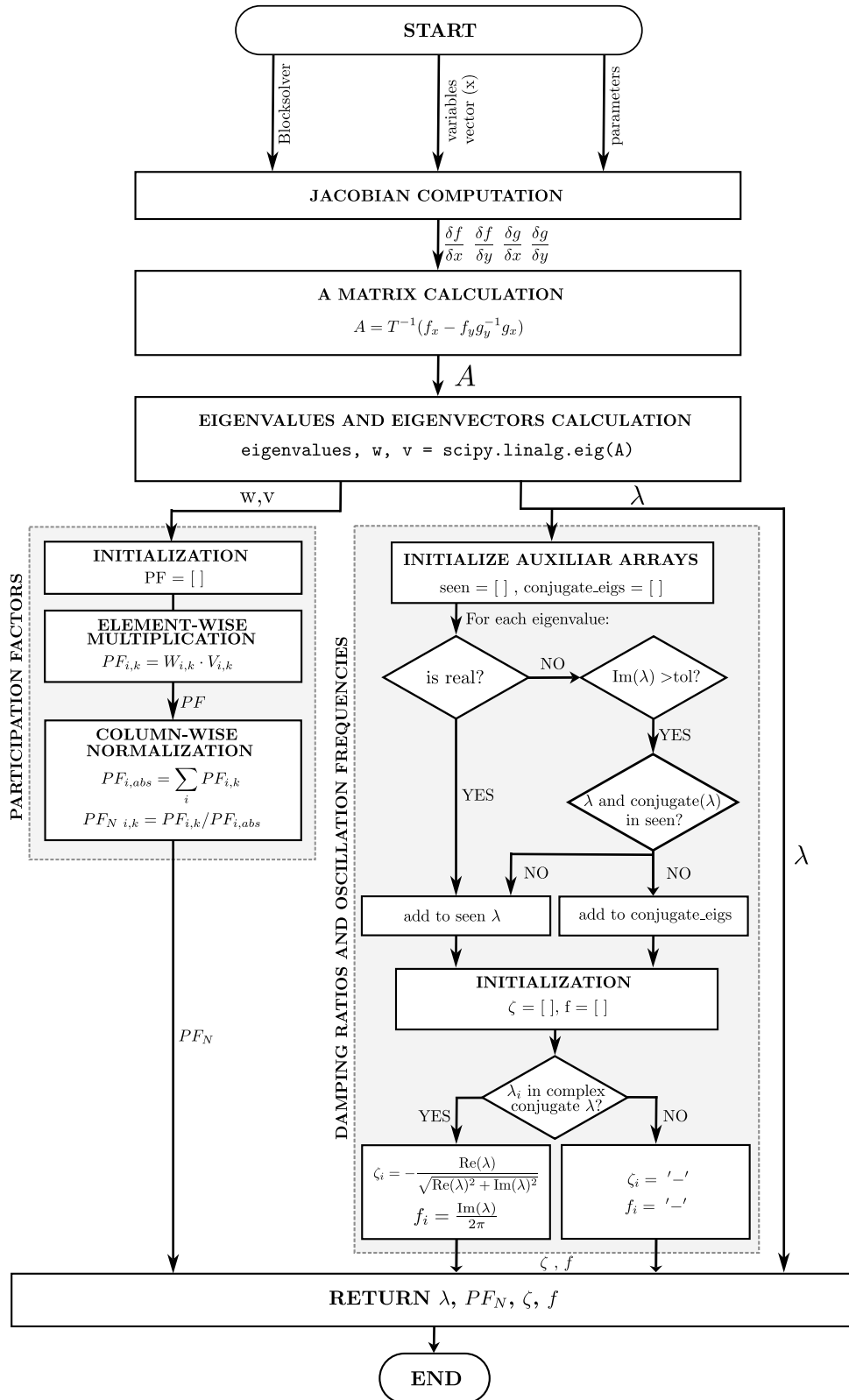


Figure 3.4: Small-signal stability analysis computation block diagram.

3.2.2 GUI implementation

The GUI is created using the open source program Qt Designer [**qt_designer**], which allows to create the GUI using a drag and drop interface. The GUI implementation consists on creating a new settings page for the small-signal stability analysis, adding the option to run the simulation in the main tools bar, and creating a new results page to show the results of the simulation. The GUI implementation is not only adding the new pages, but also connecting the GUI with the code developed in Python.

However, the first initial step is to choose an icon for the small-signal stability analysis that will be shown in the tools bar and will help users identify the option. The icon chosen is shown in Figure 3.5. The icon represents a magnifying glass looking at a wave. The magnifying glass represents the small-signal analysis, which works around a small perturbation and a small interval around the operating point, so the user needs the magnifying glass to see those small perturbations. The wave represents the system variables represented in the time domain, which are the ones that will be analyzed in the small-signal stability analysis.

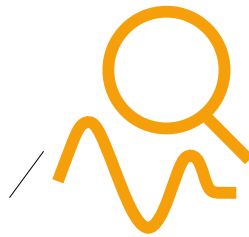


Figure 3.5: Icon for the small-signal stability analysis.

The settings page shown in Figure 3.6 allows the user to set the parameters needed for the small-signal stability analysis. It is noted how the small-signal settings are added into the dynamic simulation settings and there is only one setting: the assessment time. If assessment time is not zero a RMS dynamic simulation ending at assessment time must be performed. Therefore, the RMS settings are as well important to look at when performing a Small-signal assessment. The settings shown are explained in the list below.

Small-signal setting:

1. *Assessment time (s)*: The time instant in seconds where the stability assessment is performed.

RMS settings:

1. *Integration method*: The integration method to use if the RMS dynamic simulation is per-

formed. There are two options: trapezoidal or implicit euler.

2. *Tolerance*: per-unit error tolerance to use in the integration method. Only needed if the Rms dynamic simulation is performed.
3. *Time step (s)*: Step size in seconds between each numerical evaluation in the integration method. Smaller intervals increase accuracy but require more computation. Only needed if the RMS dynamic simulation is performed.

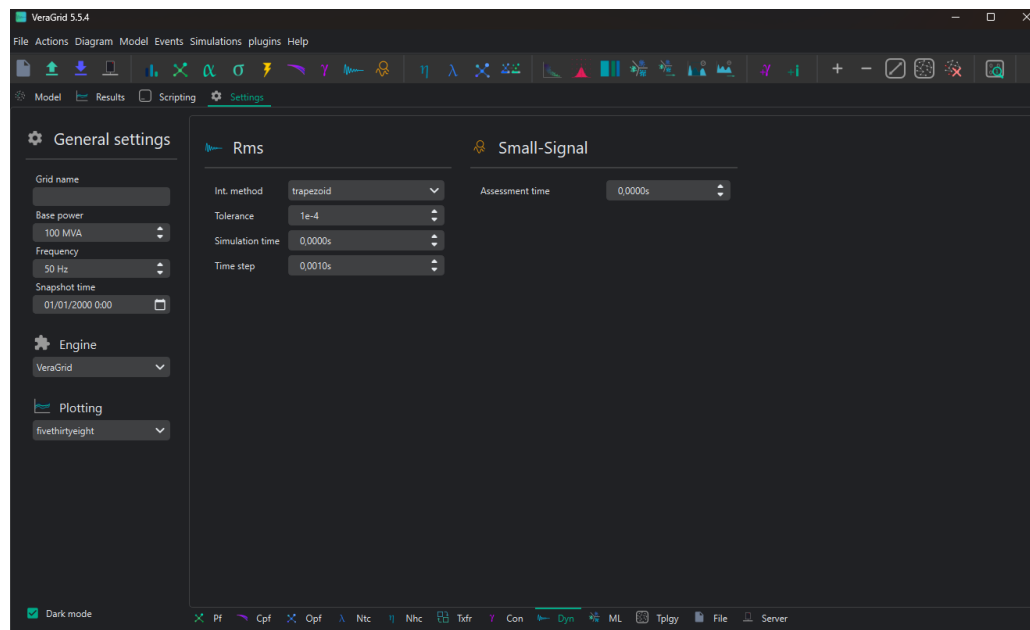


Figure 3.6: Small-signal stability analysis settings page.

The small-signal stability analysis can only be performed if the power flow has been computed, as it is needed to obtain the operating point of the system.

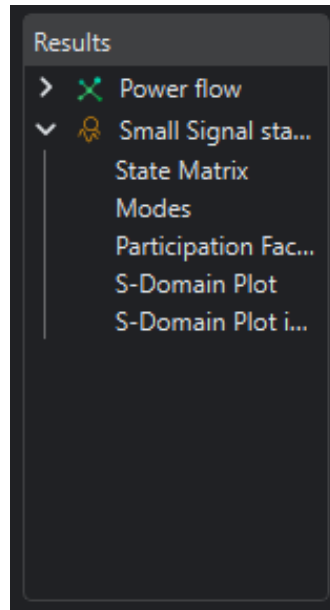


Figure 3.7: Results dropdown.

The results page shows the results of all the simulations performed in VeraGrid. The user can choose the results to show using the dropdown menu shown in Figure 3.7. In this case, the power flow and small-signal stability analysis results are shown. As one can see, the small-signal results are divided into 5 options: the state matrix, the modes table, the participation factors table, the complex domain plot and the complex domain plot in Hz. These results are shown in Figures 3.8, 3.9, 3.10, 3.11 and 3.12 respectively.

	deltagen 0	omegagen 0	deltagen 1	omegagen 1	deltagen 2	omegagen 2	deltagen 3	omegagen 3	deltagen 4	omegagen 4
0: Equation 0	0	376.991118	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
1: Equation 1	-2.348395	-4.000000	2.127087	0	0.074038	0	0.111326	0	0.035944	0
2: Equation 2	0	0	0	376.991118	0	0	0	0	0	0
3: Equation 3	1.999404	0	-3.173798	-4.000000	0.803730	0	0.250694	0	0.119970	0
4: Equation 4	0	0	0	0	0	376.991118	0	0	0	0
5: Equation 5	0.060923	0	0.737775	0	-0.977347	-4.000000	0.105418	0	0.073232	0
6: Equation 6	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	376.991118	0	0
7: Equation 7	0.108029	0	0.235939	0	0.102567	0	-0.611307	-4.000000	0.164772	0
8: Equation 8	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	376.991118
9: Equation 9	0.036113	0	0.116812	0	0.071227	0	0.160016	0	-0.384169	-4.000000

Figure 3.8: Table result with the state matrix.

	Real	Imaginary	Damping ratio	Oscillation frequency
0: Mode 0	-1.999999999999991	43.134764875209456	0.046316553039368706	6.865111048996247
1: Mode 1	-1.999999999999991	-43.134764875209456	-	-
2: Mode 2	-2.000000000000002	22.315295098173767	0.08926682293398204	3.551589521428697
3: Mode 3	-2.000000000000002	-22.315295098173767	-	-
4: Mode 4	1.1675638183136432e-14	0.0	-	-
5: Mode 5	-2.0000000000000013	16.807701792552095	0.11815947755298381	2.675028822299176
6: Mode 6	-2.0000000000000013	-16.807701792552095	-	-
7: Mode 7	-1.999999999999998	12.979801242012693	0.15228832723936697	2.0657995280166426
8: Mode 8	-1.999999999999998	-12.979801242012693	-	-
9: Mode 9	-4.000000000000011	0.0	-	-

Figure 3.9: Table result with the modes, damping ratio and oscillation frequencies.

	Mode 0	Mode 1	Mode 2	Mode 3	Mode 4	Mode 5	Mode 6	Mode 7	Mode 8	Mode 9
0: deltagen 0	0.187576	0.187576	0.161546	0.161546	0.184218	0.014712	0.014712	0.044056	0.044056	0.000000
1: omegagen 0	0.187576	0.187576	0.161546	0.161546	0.000000	0.014712	0.014712	0.044056	0.044056	0.184218
2: deltagen 1	0.302303	0.302303	0.047806	0.047806	0.195215	0.013639	0.013639	0.038644	0.038644	0.000000
3: omegagen 1	0.302303	0.302303	0.047806	0.047806	0.000000	0.013639	0.013639	0.038644	0.038644	0.195215
4: deltagen 2	0.009750	0.009750	0.287054	0.287054	0.210886	0.044659	0.044659	0.053094	0.053094	0.000000
5: omegagen 2	0.009750	0.009750	0.287054	0.287054	0.000000	0.044659	0.044659	0.053094	0.053094	0.210886
6: deltagen 3	0.000295	0.000295	0.003527	0.003527	0.203850	0.393858	0.393858	0.000395	0.000395	0.000000
7: omegagen 3	0.000295	0.000295	0.003527	0.003527	0.000000	0.393858	0.393858	0.000395	0.000395	0.203850
8: deltagen 4	0.000075	0.000075	0.000067	0.000067	0.205831	0.033132	0.033132	0.363811	0.363811	0.000000
9: omegagen 4	0.000075	0.000075	0.000067	0.000067	0.000000	0.033132	0.033132	0.363811	0.363811	0.205831

Figure 3.10: Table result with the participation factors.

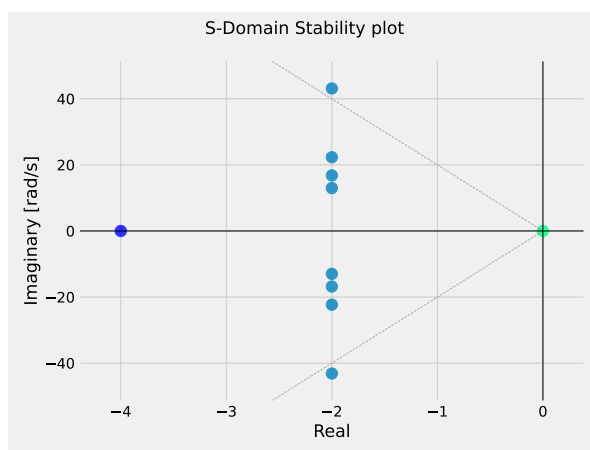


Figure 3.11: Complex domain plot.

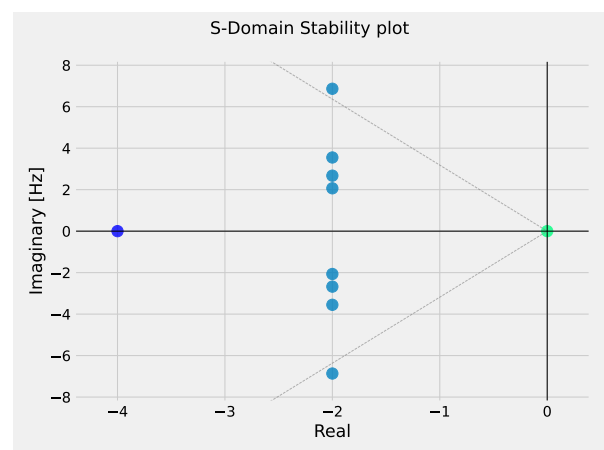


Figure 3.12: Complex domain plot in Hz.

In the eigenvalue plots, the user can take a look at the eigenvalues exact values by hovering the

mouse over the points. Moreover, the 5% damping ratio line is shown to help the user identify the oscillatory modes. It should also be noted that the color of the modes is determined by their real part. Therefore, the mode with the largest real part (the dominant mode) will be the darkest, and the mode with the smallest real part will be the lightest.

3.3 Benchmark and validation

The validation of the developed implementation is performed by comparing its results with those obtained using *Advanced Network Dynamics and Equilibrium Simulator* (ANDES). The comparison is carried out on the classical Kundur two-area test system, a standard benchmark for dynamic systems, enabling a direct verification of the small-signal stability analysis between both tools.

3.3.1 ANDES

Thanks to its combination of symbolic precision and robust numerical performance, *Advanced Network Dynamics and Equilibrium Simulator* (ANDES) provides an excellent reference platform for the validation of dynamic and stability analysis tools in modern power system research. Developed as an open-source framework for modelling differential-algebraic systems, ANDES enables a fully symbolic formulation of network equations and control models, which ensures reproducibility and analytical transparency across a wide range of test systems. For these reasons, ANDES is widely recognised as a reliable benchmark for many types of simulations such as small-signal stability studies and has been used here as the reference software against which the performance of VeraGrid has been assessed.

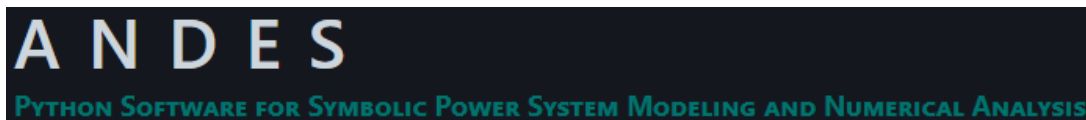


Figure 3.13: ANDES logo. Source: ANDES documentation [8].

VeraGrid imports ANDES models directly from standardized .json files, allowing the seamless translation of system data, dynamic models, and numerical parameters. Once imported, VeraGrid performs the ANDES small-signal stability computations internally, based on ANDES numerical engine. The results obtained from VeraGrid have been compared with those from ANDES. VeraGrid successfully reproduces the full set of eigenvalues, damping ratios, and oscillation frequencies computed by ANDES, confirming the equivalence of its linearisation procedures and numerical solvers.

Beyond direct eigenvalue matching, the validation process also includes the comparison of mode shapes, damping factors, and participation factors matrices to ensure consistency in both

the algebraic formulation and numerical sensitivity of the two tools. These extended checks are essential to confirm that the dynamic responses, not only the eigenvalue, coincide under identical modelling assumptions. In practice, this guarantees that VeraGrid preserves the physical interpretation of oscillatory modes and stability margins originally provided by ANDES, while operating within its own software framework.

In the following subsection the Kundur two-area system is used as a benchmark test case to illustrate the accuracy of VeraGrid in reproducing ANDES results.

3.3.2 Test case: Kundur two-area system

The Kundur two-area system is a standard benchmark network widely used for small-signal and transient stability studies. It was introduced in the P. Kundur power system stability literature [3] as a compact, yet representative, test case that exposes inter-area oscillatory modes and control interactions without excessive model complexity.

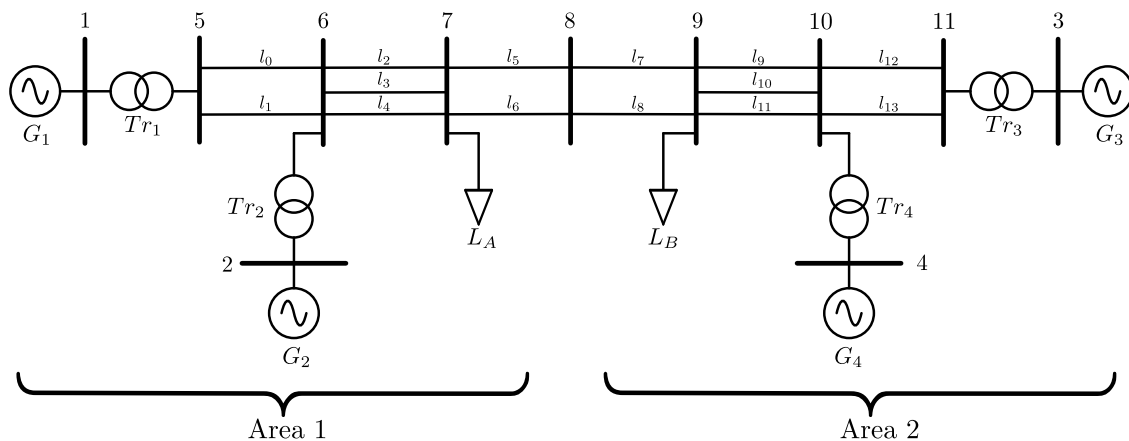


Figure 3.14: Kundur two-area system without shunt.

Figure 3.14 shows the one-line diagram of the Kundur two-area system without shunt. The main characteristics of the system are the following:

- There are two areas connected by a pair of parallel lines. In each area, 2 synchronous generators are placed so that each area can swing against each other and produce inter-area oscillations.
- All the synchronous generators are connected to the network through a transformer.
- In this version of the Kundur two-area system no shunts are connected to buses 7 and 9.
- While the system seems exactly symmetrical, the loads and generators are not exactly

equal. This provokes the need of power exchange between areas.

Table 3.1 summarizes the parameters of the system.

Table 3.1: Main parameters of the Kundur two-area system without shunts.

Element	Parameter	Symbol / Value	Units / Notes
Buses			
Bus1 to 4	Nominal voltage	20	kV
Bus5 to 11	Nominal voltage	230	kV
Generators			
G1, G2 G3, G4	Nominal Power	900	MVA
	Nominal voltage	20	kV
	Inertia constant	$M = 13$	s
	Damping coefficient	$D = 10$	–
	Impedances	$r_a = 0, 0, x_d = 0, 3$	p.u.
	Nominal Power	900	MVA
	Nominal voltage	20	kV
	Inertia constant	$M = 12, 35$	s
	Damping coefficient	$D = 10$	–
	Impedances	$r_a = 0, 0, x_d = 0, 3$	p.u.
Transformers			
Tr 1, 2, 3, 4	Impedance	$R = 0, 0, X = 0, 15, B = 0, 0$	p.u.
	Rate	900	MVA
Transmission lines			
Line 0, 1, 12, 13	Impedance	$R = 0, 005, X = 0, 05, B = 0, 02187$	p.u.
	Rate	750	MVA
Line 2, 3, 4, 9, 10, 11	Impedance	$R = 0, 003, X = 0, 03, B = 0, 00583$	p.u.
	Rate	700	MVA
Line 5, 6, 7, 8 (tie-line)	Impedance	$R = 0, 011, X = 0, 11, B = 0, 19250$	p.u.
	Rate	400	MVA
Loads			
Load A	Power	$P_L = 967, Q_L = 100$	MW, Mvar
Load B	Power	$P_L = 1767, Q_L = 100$	MW, Mvar

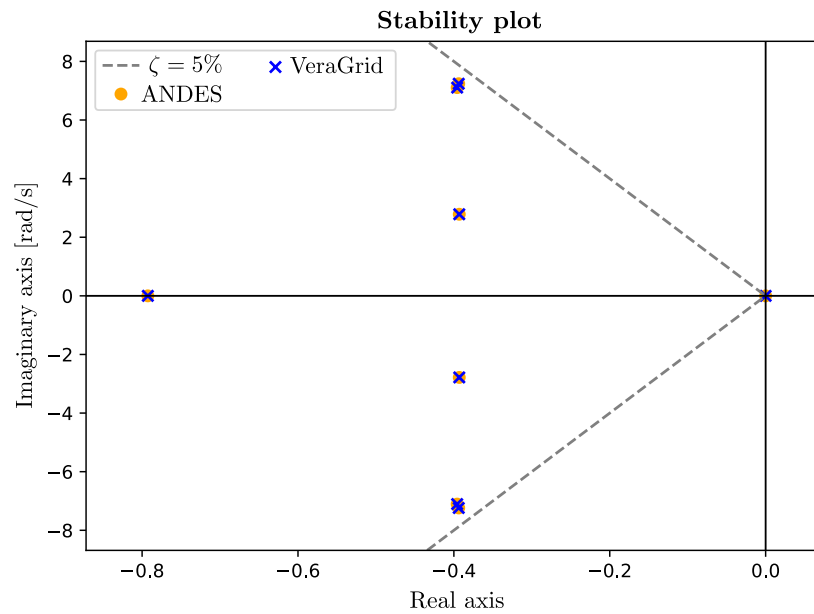


Figure 3.15: Andes vs VeraGrid complex domain plot comparison.

Figure 3.15 shows the comparison in the complex plane of the eigenvalues obtained with VeraGrid and Andes for the Kundur two-area system without shunts, while Tables 3.2 and 3.3 show the modes, damping ratios, oscillation frequencies and participation factors of the system. The results between Andes and VeraGrid are practically identical, with less than 0,0001% absolute error, this one due to numerical computation differences.

Table 3.2: Modes, damping ratios and oscillation frequencies of the Kundur Two-Area System.

Mode	Real part	Imaginary part	Damping ratio	Oscillation Frequency [Hz]
Mode 0	-0,3938	7,2377	0,0543	1,1519
Mode 1	-0,3938	-7,2377	–	–
Mode 2	-0,3958	7,1061	0,0556	1,1310
Mode 3	-0,3958	-7,1061	–	–
Mode 4	-0,3931	2,7838	0,1398	0,4431
Mode 5	-0,3931	-2,7838	–	–
Mode 6	0,0000	0,0000	–	–
Mode 7	-0,7926	0,0000	–	–

Table 3.3: Participation factors of the Kundur two-area system.

State/Mode	Mode 0	Mode 1	Mode 2	Mode 3	Mode 4	Mode 5	Mode 6	Mode 7
δ_1	0,123	0,123	0,102	0,102	0,174	0,174	0,197	0,006
ω_1	0,123	0,123	0,102	0,102	0,174	0,174	0,000	0,197
δ_2	0,151	0,151	0,122	0,122	0,117	0,117	0,214	0,006
ω_2	0,151	0,151	0,122	0,122	0,117	0,117	0,000	0,214
δ_3	0,103	0,103	0,157	0,157	0,102	0,102	0,283	0,006
ω_3	0,103	0,103	0,156	0,156	0,102	0,102	0,000	0,272
δ_4	0,123	0,123	0,119	0,119	0,108	0,108	0,306	0,006
ω_4	0,123	0,123	0,119	0,119	0,107	0,107	0,000	0,293

The small-signal stability analysis of the Kundur two-area system shows that the system is asymptotically stable, despite the presence of one zero eigenvalue associated with the rigid-body motion. Three oscillatory mode pairs are identified: two local modes around 1,14 Hz with damping ratios of about 5,5%, and one inter-area mode at 0,44 Hz with a damping ratio of 13,98%. In addition, two real modes appear, the dominant pole -0,7962 corresponding to a fast mechanical decay and another representing the neutral reference frame.

The local modes are associated with oscillations of the generators within the same area against one another. In this case, two pairs of complex conjugate eigenvalues located at $-0,3938 \pm j7,2377$ and $-0,3958 \pm j7,1061$ correspond to frequencies of 1,1519 and 1,1310 Hz respectively with damping ratios near 5,5%. These modes involve mainly the rotor angles and speeds of generators within each area, indicating local electromechanical interactions between closely coupled machines. The higher frequencies reflect the local nature of these oscillations, which are typically faster than inter-area modes due to the stronger electrical coupling and lower inertia involved. The relatively low damping (just above the threshold 5%) means that oscillations at these frequencies would decay slowly after a disturbance, and therefore these modes are usually targeted for improvement through power system stabilizers designed to increase the effective damping while maintaining the natural frequency range around one hertz.

The inter-area mode, represented by the eigenvalue pair $-0,3931 \pm j2,7838$, exhibits a frequency of 0,4431 Hz and a damping ratio of 13,98%. The participation factors show that the mode involves the collective motion of generators in one area oscillating against those in the other, with all machines in each group moving coherently. This behavior reflects the exchange of power through the tie-line connecting the two subsystems, which gives rise to slow, large-scale oscillations of the inter-area type. The relatively higher damping compared with the local modes suggests that the tie-line contribute sufficient stabilizing torque under the present operating point. Nevertheless, variations in power transfer or network strength could reduce this damp-

ing and make the inter-area oscillation more critical, as observed in many large interconnected grids.

Among the real modes, one negative mode at approximately $-0,7926$ represents a non-oscillatory but fast-decaying mode, mainly related to the mechanical dynamics of the generating units. Its time constant ($\tau = -1/\text{Re}(\lambda)$), around $1,26$ s, indicates a rapid stabilizing effect that brings the system back to equilibrium after active-power mismatches or primary control actions. This mode is considered dominant in the sense that it governs the short-term return to balance but does not limit the overall stability margins of the system.

Finally, the eigenvalue located at the origin, $\lambda = 0$, corresponds to the uniform or rigid-body mode. Mathematically, it indicates marginal stability, as perturbations projected onto this mode neither grow nor decay. Physically, however, it simply reflects the absence of an absolute angular reference: if all generator rotor angles are shifted by the same constant, the electrical state of the system remains unchanged. Only differences in rotor angles carry physical meaning, so this mode has no effect on the stability of the relative motion among machines. In practical studies, this degree of freedom is not considered for the stability analysis. Consequently, although the rigid-body mode is formally marginally stable, it is not regarded as a sign of instability in the power system.

These results are consistent with the classical interpretation of the two-area system and confirm its suitability as a benchmark for dynamic studies.

4 EMT Dynamic framework

Electromagnetic transient (EMT) simulation focuses on resolving the instantaneous behaviour of electrical networks when they are subject to fast and often severe disturbances. Unlike RMS or phasor-domain studies, which assume that voltages and currents remain approximately sinusoidal within each time step, EMT models compute these quantities directly in the time domain. This makes it possible to capture the full electromagnetic response of components, including switching actions, resonances, travelling waves, and short-duration dynamic interactions between converters and the grid.

Modern EMT tools are based on the numerical formulation introduced by Dommel in the late 1960s and subsequently used in the Electromagnetic Transients Program (EMTP) [9]. In this approach, each network element is represented through an equivalent conductance and a history-dependent current source. By assembling all contributions at every time step, the simulator solves a linear algebraic system of the form:

$$[G] [v(t)] = [i(t)] - [I_{\text{hist}}] \quad (4.1)$$

where $[G]$ is the global conductance matrix of the network, $v(t)$ is the vector of node voltages, $i(t)$ contains the instantaneous current injections, and $i_{\text{hist}}(t)$ represents the history terms accumulated from previous time steps. This formulation is flexible and allows linear, nonlinear, and power-electronic elements to be incorporated into the same solution process. This type of solver is called a Modified Nodal Analysis (MNA) solver.

EMT simulation is essential whenever the assumptions of RMS-based dynamic studies no longer hold. RMS models use phasors to represent voltages and currents, and they rely on the idea that the waveform remains nearly sinusoidal. This approximation is often sufficient for analysing electromechanical behaviour, such as rotor-angle stability, slow voltage dynamics, or generator control interactions, where the dominant time constants range from tens of milliseconds to several seconds [3].

However, RMS models inherently filter out high-frequency and sub-cycle behaviour. They cannot accurately represent:

- Switching transients in power-electronic converters.
- Transformer inrush and magnetic saturation.
- Lightning impulses and surge propagation.
- Fast protection and relay actions.

- Travelling waves on overhead lines and underground cables.
- Harmonic and resonance interactions.
- Instabilities driven by phase-locked loops or weak-grid conditions.

All these phenomena unfold at microsecond to millisecond time scales and require explicit time-domain resolution. EMT simulation is therefore the only method capable of capturing the detailed electromagnetic response of a system under such conditions. This has become particularly important in converter-dominated grids, where the interaction between fast control loops and grid dynamics may lead to oscillations or instabilities that RMS simulations cannot reveal.

In practice, EMT simulation is used to:

- Analyse the internal behaviour of converter controllers,
- Validate protection algorithms relying on high-speed measurements,
- Assess resonance propagation along cables and transformers,
- Evaluate insulation coordination and surge propagation,
- Study black-start and grid-forming behaviour,
- Examine the detailed impact of grid faults on converter-rich systems.

Although RMS and EMT simulations aim to describe power-system behaviour, they operate at very different levels of detail. The main conceptual differences are summarised below:

- *Waveform representation:* RMS models use phasors, assuming sinusoidal waveforms with slowly varying magnitude and phase. EMT models compute instantaneous voltages and currents, allowing arbitrary waveform distortion.
- *Time resolution:* RMS simulations typically use time steps between 1–10 ms. EMT simulations use time steps in the range of 20–50 μs , or even smaller when needed.
- *Phenomena captured:* RMS simulations focus on electromechanical dynamics and long-term voltage behaviour. EMT simulations capture electromagnetic transients, converter switching, resonances, saturation, and sub-cycle interactions.
- *Computational requirements:* RMS simulations are computationally efficient and scale well to large networks. EMT simulations require significantly more computation but provide the detail needed to study fast or nonlinear phenomena.

Both approaches are complementary. RMS simulation remains essential for system-wide stability and planning studies, while EMT simulation is indispensable for detailed transient analysis, validation of protection schemes, and the study of power-electronic behaviour in modern grids.

4.1 Line Model: Bergeron's Model

Accurate modelling of transmission lines is essential in electromagnetic transient (EMT) simulation because wave propagation, reflections, and attenuation determine the fast behaviour of the network during disturbances. Lumped representations such as the classical π -model are widely used in steady-state and RMS dynamic analysis; however, their structural assumptions make them inadequate for EMT studies. A π -model represents the line using a single series impedance and two shunt admittances, implicitly assuming that the line is electrically short relative to the wavelength of interest and that propagation effects can be neglected. Such a representation introduces neither the propagation delay nor the distributed nature of the line parameters, and therefore cannot reproduce travelling waves, reflection phenomena, refraction at line terminations, or frequency-dependent attenuation. Although subdividing the line into multiple cascaded π -sections improves accuracy, it also increases numerical stiffness and computational cost, making it unsuitable as the foundation of an EMT solver [9].

For EMT simulation, the model must preserve the distributed nature of the line as described by the telegrapher's equations. A representation fulfilling this requirement while remaining computationally efficient is the Bergeron travelling-wave model, originally formulated for EMTP-type tools. The model introduces the characteristic impedance and the propagation delay directly into the nodal formulation, enabling a physically meaningful description of wave propagation with excellent numerical stability. This makes Bergeron's method particularly appropriate for the development of foundational EMT solvers.

4.1.1 From Telegrapher's Equations to the Bergeron's line Model

For a lossless transmission line, the distributed parameters reduce to an inductance per unit length L' and a capacitance per unit length C' . Under this assumption, the telegrapher's equations take the form:

$$\frac{\partial v(x, t)}{\partial x} = -L' \frac{\partial i(x, t)}{\partial t}, \quad (4.2)$$

$$\frac{\partial i(x, t)}{\partial x} = -C' \frac{\partial v(x, t)}{\partial t}. \quad (4.3)$$

Differentiating each equation with respect to x and t and substituting leads to two wave equations:

$$\frac{\partial^2 v(x, t)}{\partial x^2} = L' C' \frac{\partial^2 v(x, t)}{\partial t^2}, \quad (4.4)$$

$$\frac{\partial^2 i(x, t)}{\partial x^2} = L' C' \frac{\partial^2 i(x, t)}{\partial t^2}. \quad (4.5)$$

The general solution of these equations is a superposition of forward- and backward-travelling waves,

$$v(x, t) = v^+(t - x/v) + v^-(t + x/v), \quad (4.6)$$

$$i(x, t) = \frac{1}{Z_c} v^+(t - x/v) - \frac{1}{Z_c} v^-(t + x/v), \quad (4.7)$$

where the characteristic impedance and wave velocity are

$$Z_c = \sqrt{\frac{L'}{C'}}, \quad v = \frac{1}{\sqrt{L' C'}}. \quad (4.8)$$

At the sending terminal ($x = 0$) and receiving terminal ($x = \ell$), these expressions become:

$$v_f(t) = v^+(t) + v^-(t), \quad (4.9)$$

$$i_f(t) = \frac{1}{Z_c} (v^+(t) - v^-(t)), \quad (4.10)$$

$$v_t(t) = v^+(t - \tau) + v^-(t + \tau), \quad (4.11)$$

$$i_t(t) = \frac{1}{Z_c} (v^+(t - \tau) - v^-(t + \tau)), \quad (4.12)$$

where $\tau = \ell/v$ is the propagation delay.

Solving these relationships for v^+ and v^- and eliminating them yields the Norton-type expressions used in the Bergeron's model. The current at each terminal can be written as the sum of an instantaneous contribution through the characteristic impedance and a history-dependent term:

$$i_{f,t}(t) = \frac{1}{Z_c} v_f(t) + I_{\text{hist},f}(t - \tau), \quad (4.13)$$

$$i_{t,f}(t) = \frac{1}{Z_c} v_t(t) + I_{\text{hist},t}(t - \tau), \quad (4.14)$$

with history currents

$$I_{\text{hist},f}(t - \tau) = -\frac{1}{Z_c} v_t(t - \tau) - i_{t,f}(t - \tau), \quad (4.15)$$

$$I_{\text{hist},t}(t - \tau) = -\frac{1}{Z_c} v_f(t - \tau) - i_{f,t}(t - \tau). \quad (4.16)$$

This formulation expresses each terminal of the line as a Norton equivalent consisting of a conductance $1/Z_c$ in parallel with a current source dependent on delayed voltages and currents. As a result, the model integrates naturally into the nodal-analysis framework of EMT solvers and preserves the essential physics of wave propagation.

Figure 4.1 illustrates the Bergeron's lossless line model, highlighting the characteristic impedance and history-current sources.

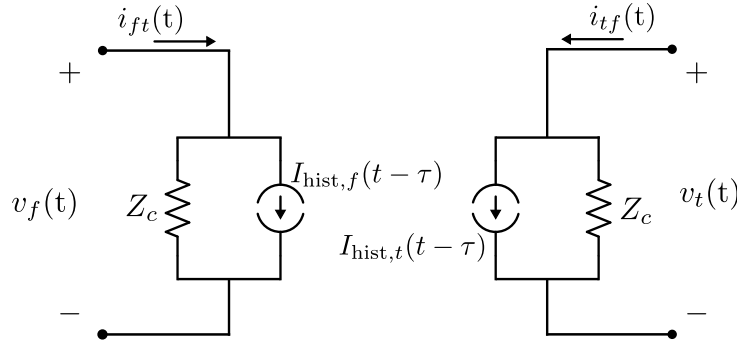


Figure 4.1: Bergeron's lossless line model.

4.1.2 Bergeron's line Model with Lumped Resistances

Real transmission lines exhibit losses; therefore, the model must incorporate attenuation. A standard EMT approximation introduces the total series resistance R by splitting the line into two halves and representing each half with its own Bergeron equivalent. Each half has $R/4$ resistances added to each terminal, effectively distributing the losses along the line. Figure 4.2 shows this configuration.

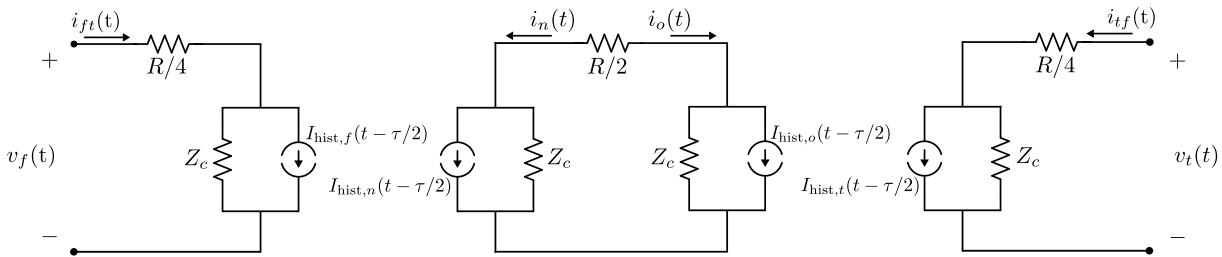


Figure 4.2: Bergeron's line model with lumped resistance.

Splitting the resistance modifies the apparent characteristic impedance of each half-line. The equivalent becomes

$$Z = Z_c + \frac{R}{4}, \quad (4.17)$$

because each resistor of value $R/2$ is divided in two and attached symmetrically to each end. This adjustment introduces attenuation in the travelling wave components. The attenuation

coefficient is defined as

$$H = \frac{Z_c - R/4}{Z_c + R/4}, \quad (4.18)$$

and governs the damping of each travelling wave as it propagates through the resistive sections.

The half-line equivalent, shown in Fig. 4.3, leads to a history current of the form:

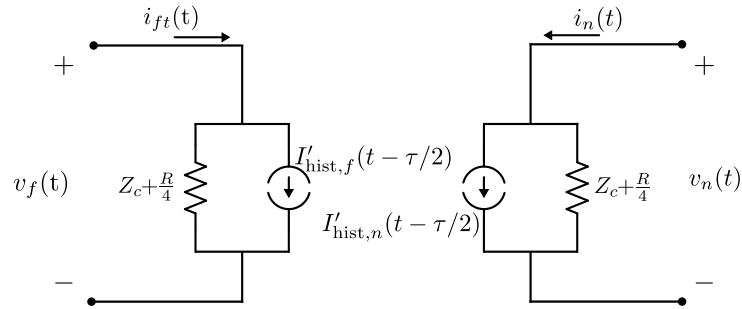


Figure 4.3: Half Bergeron line model with lumped resistance.

$$I_{\text{hist},m}(t - \tau/2) = -\frac{1}{Z_c + R/4}v_m(t - \tau/2) - H i_m(t - \tau/2). \quad (4.19)$$

This expression already reflects both the propagation delay and the attenuation due to the series resistance.

To recover a two-terminal equivalent, the contributions of the two half-lines are combined, producing the structure in Fig. 4.4. The resulting history current at the sending terminal is a weighted combination of delayed voltages and currents at both ends:

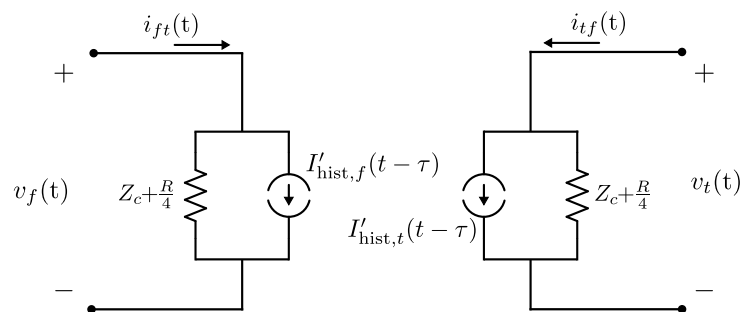


Figure 4.4: Bergeron's line model with lumped resistance two-nodes equivalent.

$$I_{\text{hist},f}(t - \tau) = \left(\frac{1+H}{2}\right) \left(-\frac{1}{Z}v_t(t - \tau) - i_{t,f}(t - \tau)\right) + \left(\frac{1-H}{2}\right) \left(-\frac{1}{Z}v_f(t - \tau) - i_{f,t}(t - \tau)\right), \quad (4.20)$$

and by symmetry,

$$I_{\text{hist},t}(t - \tau) = \left(\frac{1+H}{2} \right) \left(-\frac{1}{Z} v_f(t - \tau) - i_{f,t}(t - \tau) \right) + \left(\frac{1-H}{2} \right) \left(-\frac{1}{Z} v_t(t - \tau) - i_{t,f}(t - \tau) \right). \quad (4.21)$$

This formulation retains the travelling wave nature of the line while providing a realistic approximation of attenuation and energy dissipation. It remains numerically stable and computationally efficient, making it well-suited for foundational EMT solver development. In later stages, this representation may be replaced by a frequency-dependent line model, which more accurately captures dispersion and broadband attenuation effects.

4.1.3 Three-Phase and Multiconductor Line Implementation

The travelling-wave formulation used for single-phase lines extends naturally to systems with several conductors. Electromagnetic transient (EMT) simulation requires explicit representation of each conductor, since fast disturbances propagate through coupled electromagnetic modes determined by mutual inductances and capacitances. For this reason, the implementation adopts a general multiconductor framework capable of modelling an arbitrary number of phases, including one-phase, two-phase, three-phase, and with or without neutral configurations. This flexibility allows accurate treatment of networks where conductor geometry or availability changes across sections.

The formulation begins with the computation of the distributed impedance and admittance matrices per unit length, denoted by $\mathbf{Z}'$ and $\mathbf{Y}'$. These matrices are derived from Carson's formulas, which incorporate both self and mutual coupling among conductors and remain the established foundation for overhead line parameter calculation [carson1926]. The matrices are expressed as

$$\mathbf{Z}' = \mathbf{R}' + j\omega\mathbf{L}', \quad (4.22)$$

$$\mathbf{Y}' = \mathbf{G}' + j\omega\mathbf{C}'. \quad (4.23)$$

For a Bergeron-type representation, the frequency-independent terms are extracted from $\mathbf{L}'$ and $\mathbf{C}'$. The multiconductor characteristic impedance and the associated conductance matrix are defined by

$$\mathbf{Z}_c = \sqrt{\mathbf{L}'\mathbf{C}'}, \quad (4.24)$$

$$\mathbf{G}_c = \mathbf{Z}_c^{-1}. \quad (4.25)$$

These expressions generalise the scalar characteristic impedance and Norton equivalent of the single-phase Bergeron's line model to the multiconductor case.

To incorporate attenuation effects, the distributed resistance matrix $\mathbf{R}'$ is included following the same principle as the single-phase lossy Bergeron model. The equivalent impedance matrix becomes

$$\mathbf{Z} = \mathbf{Z}_c + \frac{1}{4}\mathbf{R}', \quad (4.26)$$

and the attenuation matrix is defined as

$$\mathbf{H} = \left(\mathbf{Z}_c - \frac{1}{4}\mathbf{R}'\right) \left(\mathbf{Z}_c + \frac{1}{4}\mathbf{R}'\right)^{-1}. \quad (4.27)$$

These matrices describe how electromagnetic waves attenuate and interact across conductors while travelling along the line.

Although $\mathbf{Z}_c$, $\mathbf{G}_c$, and $\mathbf{H}$ are treated as matrices, the propagation delay is implemented as a scalar quantity. This choice follows standard EMT practice: Carson's derivations produce a physically meaningful self-propagation velocity based on the diagonal terms of the inductance and capacitance matrices. The wave velocity is therefore computed as

$$v = \frac{1}{\sqrt{L'_{\text{self}} C'_{\text{self}}}}, \quad (4.28)$$

and the corresponding propagation time is

$$\tau = \frac{\ell}{v}. \quad (4.29)$$

Using a single propagation delay for all conductors avoids the need for modal decomposition while maintaining adequate accuracy in EMT applications, particularly for transposed lines or configurations where the difference in modal velocities is small.

With this structure, each terminal of a multiconductor line contributes a Norton-type equivalent current defined by

$$\mathbf{i}_f(t) = \mathbf{G}_c \mathbf{v}_f(t) + \mathbf{I}_{\text{hist},f}(t - \tau), \quad (4.30)$$

$$\mathbf{i}_t(t) = \mathbf{G}_c \mathbf{v}_t(t) + \mathbf{I}_{\text{hist},t}(t - \tau). \quad (4.31)$$

The history currents are vector quantities that incorporate delayed voltages and currents from all conductors, weighted by the matrices $\mathbf{H}$ and $\mathbf{Z}$:

$$\mathbf{I}_{\text{hist},f}(t - \tau) = -\mathbf{Z}^{-1} \mathbf{v}_t(t - \tau) - \mathbf{i}_{t,f}(t - \tau), \quad (4.32)$$

$$\mathbf{I}_{\text{hist},t}(t - \tau) = -\mathbf{Z}^{-1} \mathbf{v}_f(t - \tau) - \mathbf{i}_{f,t}(t - \tau). \quad (4.33)$$

This multiconductor travelling wave representation preserves conductor coupling without requiring modal transformations and integrates efficiently into the global nodal formulation. It also provides a consistent basis for future upgrades to frequency-dependent line models, where the same matrix structure is retained while the impedance and admittance matrices become functions of frequency.

4.2 Three-phase synchronous generator

The synchronous generator is represented in the EMT solver as a Norton-equivalent current source in parallel with an admittance matrix, connected to the three-phase network at the machine terminals. At each time step, the machine model receives the terminal voltages, updates its internal electrical and mechanical states, and returns an equivalent current injection and conductance to be inserted into the modified nodal analysis (MNA) system. Figure 4.5 illustrates the EMT-type synchronous machine model adopted in this work.

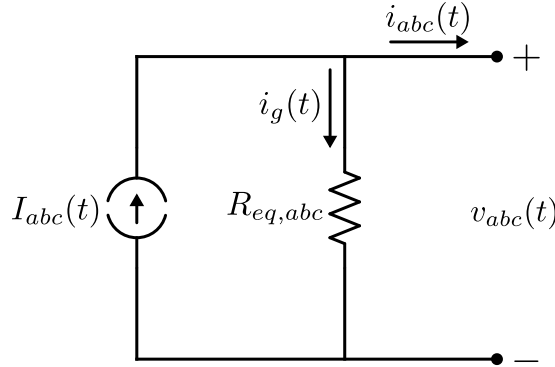


Figure 4.5: Generator EMT-type machine model.

Where:

- v_{abc} , are the phase-to-neutral stator voltages,
- i_{abc} are the phase currents injected to the network,
- I_{abc} is the Norton-equivalent current injection from the machine to the network,
- $R_{eq,abc}$ is the generator Norton-equivalent impedance matrix:

$$[R_{eq,abc}] = \begin{bmatrix} R_{eq,a} & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & R_{eq,b} & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & R_{eq,c} \end{bmatrix}, \quad (4.34)$$

Which can be computed from:

$$[R_{eq,dq0}] = \begin{bmatrix} \frac{2 L_d''}{h} & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & \frac{2 L_q''}{h} & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & \frac{2 L_0}{h} \end{bmatrix}, \quad (4.35)$$

with L_d'' , L_q'' being the subtransient inductances in d and q axis respectively, L_0 the zero-axis inductance and h the simulation timestep. $R_{eq,dq0}$ is transformed to $R_{eq,abc}$ using the Park transformation.

- i_g is the history current component computed from the previous state voltages.

$$i_g = \frac{1}{R_{eq,abc}} v_{abc}(t - h) \quad (4.36)$$

The following assumptions are adopted for an ideal synchronous machine:

- The resistance in each winding is constant.
- The permeance of each portion of the magnetic circuit is constant (corrections for saturation effects are introduced at a later stage).
- The armature windings are symmetrical with respect to each other.
- The electric and magnetic circuits of the field structure are symmetrical about the direct (d) and quadrature (q) axes.
- The self inductance of each winding on the field structure (field f' and any additional rotor windings) is constant.
- Hysteresis effects are negligible.
- Eddy-current effects are negligible or, in the case of cylindrical-rotor machines, are represented by appropriate equivalent rotor windings.

For the general EMT machine model, the following additional assumptions are adopted:

- Saliency effects are not neglected, i.e. $X_d \neq X_q$.
- Saturation effects are neglected in the initial model.
- Damper winding effects are neglected in the present implementation.
- The machine is represented as an equivalent two-pole machine. If the physical machine has p poles, the actual angular frequency and torque are recovered as

$$\omega_{\text{actual}} = \frac{\omega_{2\text{-pole}}}{p/2}, \quad (4.37)$$

$$T_{\text{actual}} = \frac{p}{2} T_{2\text{-pole}}. \quad (4.38)$$

- The quadrature axis lags the direct axis by 90° electrical.

4.2.1 Electrical part

The electrical behaviour of the three-phase stator is described by the voltage-flux linkage equations in phase variables:

$$\begin{pmatrix} v_a - i_a R_a \\ v_b - i_b R_a \\ v_c - i_c R_a \end{pmatrix} = \frac{d}{dt} \begin{pmatrix} \psi_a \\ \psi_b \\ \psi_c \end{pmatrix}, \quad (4.39)$$

where v_a, v_b, v_c are phase-to-neutral stator voltages, i_a, i_b, i_c are stator currents, R_a is the stator resistance (assumed equal in all phases), and ψ_a, ψ_b, ψ_c are the corresponding flux linkages. The field winding (referred to the stator) satisfies

$$v_f - i_f R_f = \frac{d\psi_f}{dt}, \quad (4.40)$$

where v_f is the field voltage, i_f is the field current, R_f is the field resistance and ψ_f is the field flux linkage.

For the EMT formulation, it is convenient to express the stator quantities in the rotating dq reference frame using the Park transformation. The transformation from abc to dq0 variables is

$$[T(\theta)] = \frac{2}{3} \begin{bmatrix} \cos(\theta) & \cos\left(\theta - \frac{2\pi}{3}\right) & \cos\left(\theta + \frac{2\pi}{3}\right) \\ \sin(\theta) & \sin\left(\theta - \frac{2\pi}{3}\right) & \sin\left(\theta + \frac{2\pi}{3}\right) \\ \frac{1}{2} & \frac{1}{2} & \frac{1}{2} \end{bmatrix}, \quad (4.41)$$

and the inverse transformation is

$$[T(\theta)]^{-1} = \begin{bmatrix} \cos(\theta) & \sin(\theta) & 1 \\ \cos\left(\theta - \frac{2\pi}{3}\right) & \sin\left(\theta - \frac{2\pi}{3}\right) & 1 \\ \cos\left(\theta + \frac{2\pi}{3}\right) & \sin\left(\theta + \frac{2\pi}{3}\right) & 1 \end{bmatrix}. \quad (4.42)$$

In the dq0 reference frame and for the simplified model considered (one field winding, no explicit damper windings), the stator d - and q -axis voltage equations take the form

$$v_d = R_a i_d + \frac{d}{dt} \psi_d - \omega \psi_q, \quad (4.43)$$

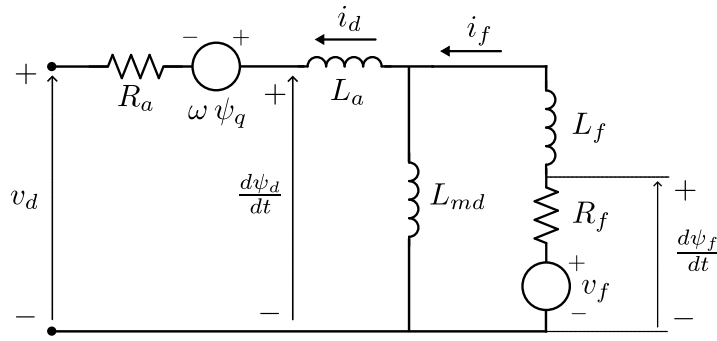
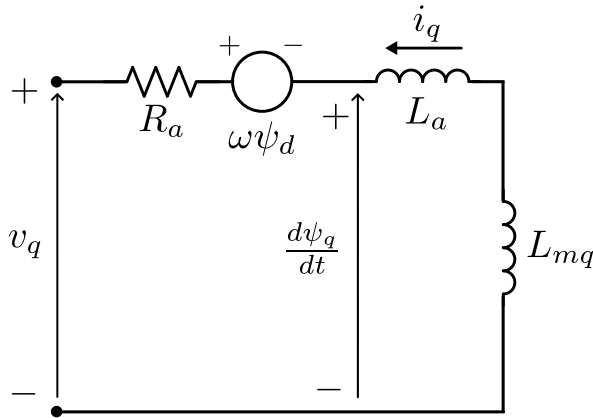
$$v_q = R_a i_q + \frac{d}{dt} \psi_q + \omega \psi_d, \quad (4.44)$$

$$v_0 = R_0 i_0 \quad (4.45)$$

and the field equation becomes

$$v_f = R_f i_f + \frac{d\psi_f}{dt}. \quad (4.46)$$

Flux linkages are expressed in terms of currents through the d - and q -axis inductances. For the d -axis, including stator leakage inductance L_a , magnetising inductance L_{md} and field inductance

Figure 4.6: Generator d -axis equivalent model.Figure 4.7: Generator q -axis equivalent model.

(referred to stator) L_a for the f' winding, the relations are

$$\begin{pmatrix} \psi_d \\ \psi_{f'} \end{pmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} L_{md} + L_a & L_{md} \\ L_{md} & L_{md} + L_a \end{bmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} i_d \\ i_{f'} \end{pmatrix}, \quad (4.47)$$

whereas for the q -axis (with magnetising inductance L_{mq} and stator leakage L_a),

$$\psi_q = (L_{mq} + L_a) i_q. \quad (4.48)$$

Figure ?? shows the equivalent d - and q -axis circuit representations corresponding to these equations.

The electromagnetic torque is obtained from the dq quantities as

$$T_e = \frac{3}{2} (\psi_d i_q - \psi_q i_d), \quad (4.49)$$

which is consistent with the adopted sign convention. This expression is used both in the mechanical equations and in the symbolic implementation of the model.

4.2.2 Mechanical part

The mechanical dynamics of the rotor are described by a two-state system in rotor angle θ and speed ω . In continuous time, the mechanical equations can be written as

$$\frac{d}{dt} \begin{pmatrix} \theta \\ \omega \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 0 & -\frac{D}{J} \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} \theta \\ \omega - \omega_{ref} \end{pmatrix} + \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ \frac{T_m - T_e}{J} \end{pmatrix}, \quad (4.50)$$

where J is the rotor inertia, D is the damping coefficient, T_m is the mechanical torque and T_e is the electromagnetic torque. In per-unit form, and using the inertia constant H and base speed ω_b , the equations are commonly written as

$$\frac{d\theta}{dt}(t) = \omega_b (\omega(t) - \omega_{ref}), \quad (4.51)$$

$$\frac{d\omega}{dt}(t) = \frac{\Gamma_m(t) - \Gamma_e(t) - D(\omega(t) - \omega_{ref})}{2H}, \quad (4.52)$$

with

$$\Gamma_m(t) = \frac{P(t)}{\omega}, \quad (4.53)$$

$$\Gamma_e(t) = \frac{3}{2} \left(i_d(t)\psi_q(t) - i_q(t)\psi_d(t) \right), \quad (4.54)$$

where $P(t)$ is the mechanical power input, and Γ_m, Γ_e denote mechanical and electromagnetic torque in per-unit.

4.2.3 Parameters determination

The EMT model requires inductances and resistances in the dq reference frame, while manufacturers typically provide parameters in the form of synchronous, transient and subtransient reactances and time constants. The known quantities are

- R_a : armature resistance (also called stator resistance),
- X_l : armature leakage reactance,
- X_0 : zero-sequence reactance,
- R_0 : zero-sequence resistance,
- X_d, X_q : synchronous reactances,
- X'_d, X'_q : transient reactances,
- X''_d, X''_q : subtransient reactances,
- T'_d, T'_q : transient short-circuit time constants,
- T''_d, T''_q : subtransient short-circuit time constants.

From these quantities, the required inductances and rotor parameters are obtained by standard relations. For the d -axis,

$$L_d = \frac{X_d}{\omega_b}, \quad L'_d = \frac{X'_d}{\omega_b}, \quad L''_d = \frac{X''_d}{\omega_b}, \quad (4.55)$$

and similarly for the q -axis,

$$L_q = \frac{X_q}{\omega_b}, \quad L'_q = \frac{X'_q}{\omega_b}, \quad L''_q = \frac{X''_q}{\omega_b}. \quad (4.56)$$

The magnetising inductances and rotor inductances are derived from these effective inductances and the leakage component. For instance,

$$L_{md} = L_d - L_a, \quad (4.57)$$

and the rotor branch inductances and resistances are determined from the differences between L_d , L'_d , L''_d and the corresponding time constants. An analogous procedure is followed for the q -axis. These calculations provide L_{md} , L_{mq} , L_a , L_f , and any additional rotor parameters required by the selected level of detail.

4.2.4 Transient solution

At each EMT time step, the synchronous machine model is advanced using the network solution from the previous iteration and the internal electrical and mechanical states of the generator. The complete procedure is summarised below.

1. *Park transformation of terminal voltages.* The stator terminal voltages in abc coordinates at the previous time step $t - h$ are transformed to $dq0$ variables using

$$[v_{dq0}(t - h)] = [T(\theta(t - h))] [v_{abc}(t - h)], \quad (4.58)$$

where

$$[T(\theta)] = \frac{2}{3} \begin{bmatrix} \cos(\theta) & \cos(\theta - \frac{2\pi}{3}) & \cos(\theta + \frac{2\pi}{3}) \\ \sin(\theta) & \sin(\theta - \frac{2\pi}{3}) & \sin(\theta + \frac{2\pi}{3}) \\ \frac{1}{2} & \frac{1}{2} & \frac{1}{2} \end{bmatrix}. \quad (4.59)$$

2. *Evaluation of flux-derivative terms.* Using the electrical equations in the $dq0$ frame, the derivatives of the flux linkages are computed at time t based on known quantities at $t - h$:

$$\begin{aligned} v_d &= R_a i_d + \frac{d\psi_d}{dt} - \omega \psi_q, \\ v_q &= R_a i_q + \frac{d\psi_q}{dt} + \omega \psi_d, \\ v_0 &= R_a i_0 + \frac{d\psi_0}{dt}. \end{aligned} \quad (4.60)$$

The field voltage equation remains

$$v_{f'} = R_{f'} i_{f'} + \frac{d\psi_{f'}}{dt}. \quad (4.61)$$

Thus, the flux derivatives evaluated at time t using information at time $t - h$ are:

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{d\psi_d}{dt}(t) &= v_d(t-h) - R_a i_d(t-h) - \omega(t-h) \psi_q(t-h), \\ \frac{d\psi_q}{dt}(t) &= v_q(t-h) - R_a i_q(t-h) + \omega(t-h) \psi_d(t-h), \\ \frac{d\psi_0}{dt}(t) &= v_0(t-h) - R_a i_0(t-h), \\ \frac{d\psi_{f'}}{dt}(t) &= v_{f'}(t-h) - R_{f'} i_{f'}(t-h). \end{aligned} \quad (4.62)$$

3. *Trapezoidal integration of flux linkages.* The fluxes at the new time step t are obtained by trapezoidal integration:

$$\begin{aligned} \psi_d(t) &= \psi_d(t-h) + h \frac{\frac{d\psi_d(t)}{dt} + \frac{d\psi_d(t-h)}{dt}}{2}, \\ \psi_{f'}(t) &= \psi_{f'}(t-h) + h \frac{\frac{d\psi_{f'}(t)}{dt} + \frac{d\psi_{f'}(t-h)}{dt}}{2}, \\ \psi_q(t) &= \psi_q(t-h) + h \frac{\frac{d\psi_q(t)}{dt} + \frac{d\psi_q(t-h)}{dt}}{2}, \\ \psi_0(t) &= \psi_0(t-h) + h \frac{\frac{d\psi_0(t)}{dt} + \frac{d\psi_0(t-h)}{dt}}{2}. \end{aligned} \quad (4.63)$$

4. *Computation of dq0 currents.* Once the new flux linkages are known, the dq0-axis currents are obtained from

$$\begin{pmatrix} i_d(t) \\ i_{f'}(t) \end{pmatrix} = [L_d]^{-1} \begin{pmatrix} \psi_d(t) \\ \psi_{f'}(t) \end{pmatrix}, \quad (4.64)$$

where

$$[L_d] = \begin{bmatrix} L_{md} + L_a & L_{md} \\ L_{md} & L_{md} + L_a \end{bmatrix}, \quad (4.65)$$

for the q -axis current is

$$i_q(t) = \frac{\psi_q(t)}{L_{mq} + L_a}. \quad (4.66)$$

and for the 0-axis current:

$$i_0(t) = \frac{\psi_0(t)}{L_0}. \quad (4.67)$$

5. *Update of mechanical states.* With $i_d(t)$, $i_q(t)$, $\psi_d(t)$, $\psi_q(t)$ available, the electromagnetic torque $\Gamma_e(t)$ is computed as

$$\Gamma_e(t) = -\frac{3}{2} \left(i_d(t) \psi_q(t) - i_q(t) \psi_d(t) \right). \quad (4.68)$$

The mechanical equations are then integrated (e.g. by trapezoidal rule) to obtain the updated $\omega(t)$ and $\theta(t)$, using

$$\frac{d\theta}{dt}(t) = \omega_b(\omega(t)), \quad (4.69)$$

$$\frac{d\omega}{dt}(t) = \frac{\Gamma_m(t) - \Gamma_e(t) - D(\omega(t) - \omega_{\text{ref}})}{2H}. \quad (4.70)$$

6. *Equivalent Norton quantities in dq0.* The Norton-equivalent current injection in the dq0 frame is obtained from an equivalent conductance matrix $[G_{\text{eq,dq}}]$ as

$$[I_{g,\text{dq0}}(t)] = [G_{\text{eq,dq0}}] [v_{\text{dq0}}(t - h)] \quad (4.71)$$

The specific form of $[G_{\text{eq,dq0}}]$ follows from the trapezoidal discretisation of the dq0-axis circuit equations.

7. *Transformation back to abc and MNA insertion.* The dq0 currents and Norton current injection are transformed back to phase coordinates using

$$[i_{\text{abc}}(t)] = [T(\theta(t))]^{-1} [i_{\text{dq0}}(t)], \quad (4.72)$$

$$[i_{g,\text{abc}}(t)] = [T(\theta(t))]^{-1} [I_{g,\text{dq0}}(t)], \quad (4.73)$$

and the equivalent conductance matrix in abc coordinates is

$$[G_{\text{eq,abc}}(t)] = [T(\theta(t))]^{-1} [G_{\text{eq,dq0}}] [T(\theta(t))]. \quad (4.74)$$

Finally, the Norton-equivalent current source to be inserted into the network is

$$[I_{g,\text{abc}}(t)] = [i_{\text{abc}}(t)] + [G_{\text{eq,abc}}(t)] [v_{\text{abc}}(t - h)]. \quad (4.75)$$

These contributions are added to the global MNA system to obtain the network solution at the next time step.

Figure 4.8 shows the overall interaction between the machine model and the network solution at each time step.

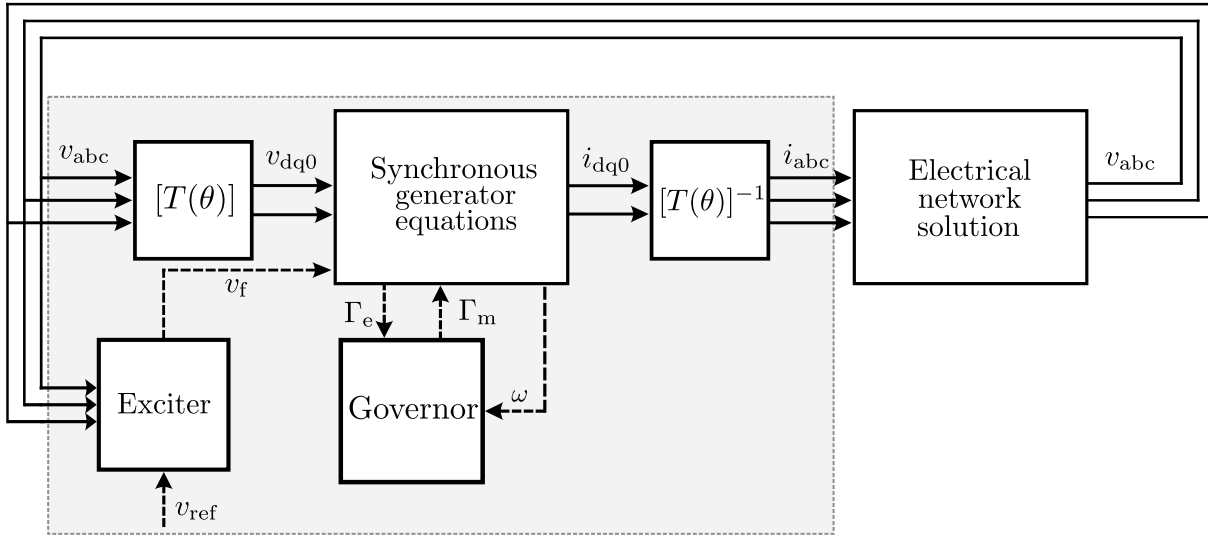


Figure 4.8: Generator EMT-type machine model and network solution process at each time step.

In the EMTDC program, synchronous machines are represented in the network by means of current injections formulated through the system admittance matrix. As in any current-injection-based interface, the injected currents are computed using terminal voltages from previous time steps. Consequently, an abrupt change in the terminal voltage does not influence the injected current until the following time step, which effectively causes the machine to behave as an open circuit during that interval. This numerical delay may produce artificial voltage spikes at the machine terminals. When several machines are connected within the same subsystem, the cumulative effect of these spikes can compromise numerical stability. To mitigate this issue, the machine model is augmented with an interfacing resistor, which introduces a direct voltage-current coupling and significantly improves the robustness of the numerical solution [10].

The value of this resistor should be chosen carefully to balance numerical stability and physical accuracy. Each commercial EMT software uses its own criteria being R between 10 and 20 times the base impedance a common choice. In VeraGrid, the interfacing resistor is set to 20 times the base impedance of the machine. The equivalent circuit of the generator model including the interfacing resistor is shown in Figure 4.9.

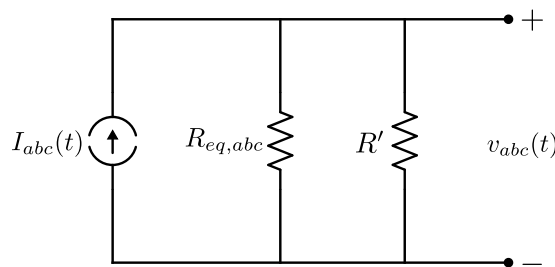


Figure 4.9: Generator EMT-type machine model including the interfacing resistor.

4.2.5 VeraGrid implementation

The generator EMT-type machine model is implemented in VeraGrid using symbolic blocks. Since the derivatives of the state variables are required at each time step, the state variables are explicitly declared as differential variables in the symbolic representation. The state variables are $\psi_d, \psi_{f'}, \psi_q, \psi_0, \theta$ and ω , with differential equations:

$$\left\{ \begin{array}{l} \frac{d\psi_d}{dt} = v_d - i_d R_a - \omega \psi_q, \\ \frac{d\psi_{f'}}{dt} = v_{f'} - R_{f'} i_{f'}, \\ \frac{d\psi_q}{dt} = v_q - R_a i_q + \omega \psi_d, \\ \frac{d\psi_0}{dt} = v_0 - R_a i_0 \\ \frac{d\theta}{dt} = \omega_b \omega, \\ \frac{d\omega}{dt} = \frac{\Gamma_m - \Gamma_e - D(\omega - \omega_{\text{ref}})}{2H} \end{array} \right. \quad (4.76)$$

The corresponding algebraic equations include the electromagnetic torque, flux-current relations and Park transformations:

$$\left\{ \begin{array}{l} \Gamma_e = -\frac{3}{2}(i_d \psi_q - i_q \psi_d), \\ \psi_d = (L_{md} + L_a)i_d + L_{md}i_{f'}, \\ \psi_{f'} = L_{md}i_d + (L_{md} + L_{f'})i_{f'}, \\ \psi_q = (L_{mq} + L_a)i_q, \\ \psi_0 = (L_0)i_0, \\ P_e = v_a i_a + v_b i_b + v_c i_c, \\ Q_e - (1/\sqrt{3})((v_a - v_b)i_c + (v_b - v_c)i_a + (v_c - v_a)i_b), i_a = \cos(\theta)i_d + \sin(\theta)i_q + i_0, \\ i_b = \cos(\theta - 2\pi/3)i_d + \sin(\theta - 2\pi/3)i_q + i_0, \\ i_c = \cos(\theta + 2\pi/3)i_d + \sin(\theta + 2\pi/3)i_q + i_0, \\ v_d = \cos(\theta)v_a + \cos(\theta - 2\pi/3)v_b + \cos(\theta + 2\pi/3)v_c, \\ v_q = \sin(\theta)v_a + \sin(\theta - 2\pi/3)v_b + \sin(\theta + 2\pi/3)v_c, \\ v_0 = 0, 5v_a + 0, 5v_b + 0, 5v_c \end{array} \right. \quad (4.77)$$

The variables v_a , v_b and v_c are taken from the network solution at the bus where the generator is connected. The field voltage v_f must be provided by the exciter model, and the mechanical torque Γ_m by the governor model.

4.2.6 Initialization of variables

The EMT-type generator model is initialised by solving the differential-algebraic equations (DAEs) under steady-state conditions using a Newton-Raphson procedure. Steady state is defined by the following assumptions:

- The derivatives of the flux and speed states are set to zero:

$$\begin{cases} \frac{d\psi_d}{dt} = 0, \\ \frac{d\psi_f}{dt} = 0, \\ \frac{d\psi_q}{dt} = 0, \\ \frac{d\psi_0}{dt} = 0, \\ \frac{d\omega}{dt} = 0 \end{cases} \quad (4.78)$$

The derivative of θ is not set to zero but is given by $\frac{d\theta}{dt} = \omega_b(\omega)$.

- The rotor speed is set to the reference value, $\omega = \omega_{\text{ref}} = 1$ p.u.
- The RMS voltages at the machine terminals v_a , v_b , v_c are set to their steady-state values, which are 1 p.u. since the RMS voltage is used as base.

Under these conditions, the steady-state differential equations reduce to

$$\begin{cases} v_d - i_d R_a - \omega \psi_q = 0, \\ v_f - R_f i_f = 0, \\ v_q - R_a i_q + \omega \psi_d = 0, \\ v_0 - R_a i_0 = 0, \\ \frac{\Gamma_m - \Gamma_e - D(\omega - \omega_{\text{ref}})}{2H} = 0, \end{cases} \quad (4.79)$$

while the algebraic relations for torques, fluxes and Park transformations retain the same form

as in (4.77), namely

$$\left\{ \begin{array}{l} T_e = -\frac{3}{2}(i_d\psi_q - i_q\psi_d), \\ \psi_d = (L_{md} + L_a)i_d + L_{md}i_{f'}, \\ \psi_{f'} = L_{md}i_d + (L_{md} + L_a)i_{f'}, \\ \psi_q = (L_{mq} + L_a)i_q, \\ \psi_0 = (L_0)i_0, \\ i_a = \cos(\theta)i_d + \sin(\theta)i_q + i_0, \\ i_b = \cos(\theta - 2\pi/3)i_d + \sin(\theta - 2\pi/3)i_q + i_0, \\ i_c = \cos(\theta + 2\pi/3)i_d + \sin(\theta + 2\pi/3)i_q + i_0, \\ v_d = \cos(\theta)v_a + \cos(\theta - 2\pi/3)v_b + \cos(\theta + 2\pi/3)v_c, \\ v_q = \sin(\theta)v_a + \sin(\theta - 2\pi/3)v_b + \sin(\theta + 2\pi/3)v_c, \\ v_0 = 0, 5v_a + 0, 5v_b + 0, 5v_c \end{array} \right. \quad (4.80)$$

Solving this steady-state DAE system provides consistent initial conditions for all state and algebraic variables of the EMT-type synchronous generator model, ensuring a smooth transition to the subsequent time-domain simulation.

4.3 Transformer

Transformers have many models depending on the grade of accuracy and the type of transformer itself. In this case, for the EMT simulation, an ideal basic transformer model is used to represent the transformer behaviour. The assumptions made for the ideal transformer are stated below.

- The transformer is modelled as an ideal transformer with no copper or iron losses.
- The leakage inductance is assumed to be equally divided between the two windings.
- The transformer is assumed to be balanced, meaning that the three phases have equal voltages and currents.

This basic transformer consists of two mutually coupled inductors. The primary winding has N_1 turns, and the secondary winding has N_2 turns. The turns ratio is defined as $a = \frac{N_1}{N_2} = \frac{v_1}{v_2} = \frac{i_2}{i_1}$ where v_1 and v_2 are the primary and secondary voltages, and i_1 and i_2 are the primary and secondary currents, respectively. The primary winding is the high voltage side, and the

secondary winding is the low voltage side. The voltages across the windings are expressed as:

$$\begin{pmatrix} v_1 \\ v_2 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} L_{11} & L_{12} \\ L_{21} & L_{22} \end{pmatrix} \frac{d}{dt} \begin{pmatrix} i_1 \\ i_2 \end{pmatrix} \quad (4.81)$$

Where L_{11} and L_{22} are the self-inductances of the primary and secondary windings, respectively, and L_{12} and L_{21} are the mutual inductances between the windings. Since the mutual coupling is bilateral, $L_{12} = L_{21}$. Equation 4.82 can be rewritten as:

$$\begin{pmatrix} v_1 \\ a v_2 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} L_{11} & L_{12} \\ a L_{21} & a^2 L_{22} \end{pmatrix} \frac{d}{dt} \begin{pmatrix} i_1 \\ i_2/a \end{pmatrix} \quad (4.82)$$

Using the relation above, the transformer equivalent circuit is shown in Figure 4.10.

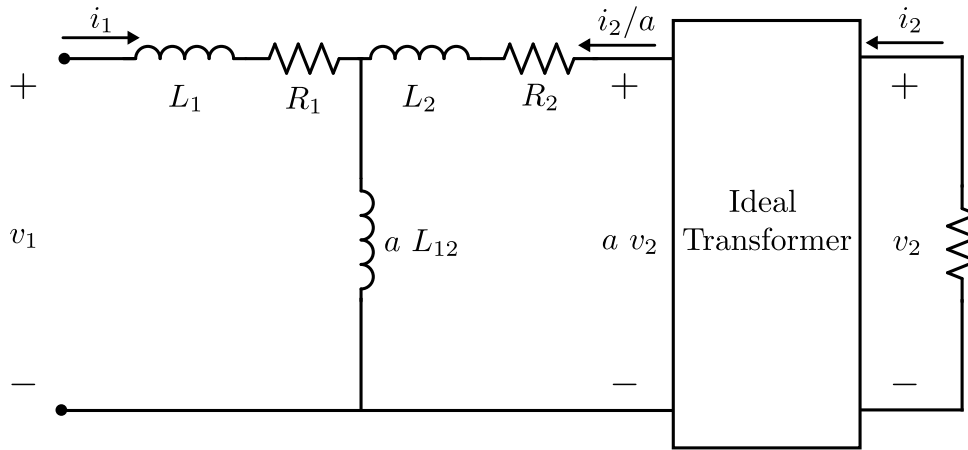


Figure 4.10: Ideal transformer equivalent circuit.

4.3.1 Numerical model in EMT

The transformer model is implemented in the EMT simulation using a numerical approach similar to that used for transmission lines using the Dommel method. Figure 4.11 shows the equivalent circuit of the transformer used in the EMT simulation.

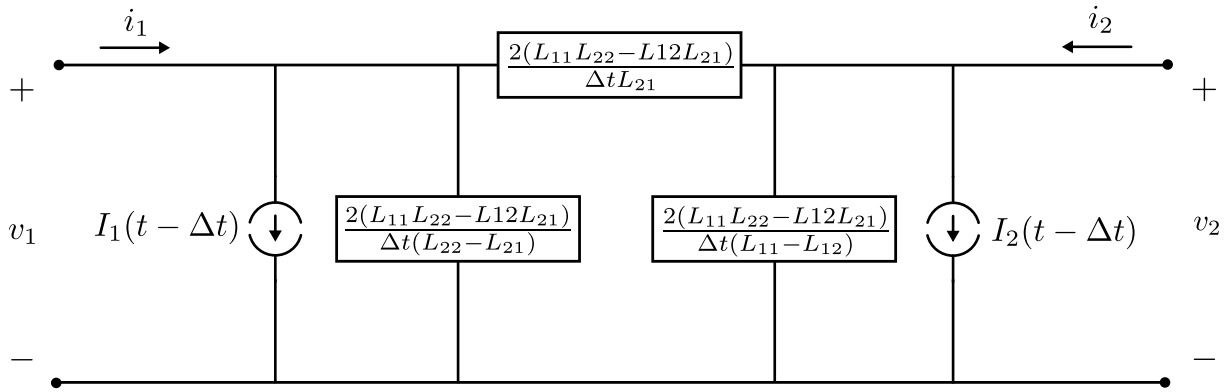


Figure 4.11: Ideal transformer equivalent circuit.

It's seen how the inductances are represented as a combination of a history component and a conductance derived from the self and mutual inductances. From equation 4.82, each winding components are separated as:

$$\frac{di_1}{dt} = \frac{L_{22}}{L_{11}L_{22} - L_{12}L_{21}} v_1 - \frac{L_{21}}{L_{11}L_{22} - L_{12}L_{21}} v_2 \quad (4.83)$$

$$\frac{di_2}{dt} = -\frac{L_{12}}{L_{11}L_{22} - L_{12}L_{21}} v_1 + \frac{L_{11}}{L_{11}L_{22} - L_{12}L_{21}} v_2 \quad (4.84)$$

$$L_1 = L_{11} - aL_{12} \quad (4.85)$$

$$L_2 = a^2L_{22} - aL_{12} \quad (4.86)$$

$$i_1(t) = I_{h1}(t - \Delta t) + \left(\frac{L_{22} \Delta t}{2(L_{11}L_{22} - L_{12}L_{21})} - \frac{L_{21} \Delta t}{2(L_{11}L_{22} - L_{12}L_{21})} \right) v_1(t) + \frac{L_{21} \Delta t}{2(L_{11}L_{22} - L_{12}L_{21})} (v_1(t) - v_2(t)) \quad (4.87)$$

$$i_2(t) = I_{h2}(t - \Delta t) + \left(\frac{L_{11} \Delta t}{2(L_{11}L_{22} - L_{12}L_{21})} - \frac{L_{21} \Delta t}{2(L_{11}L_{22} - L_{12}L_{21})} \right) v_1(t) + \frac{L_{12} \Delta t}{2(L_{11}L_{22} - L_{12}L_{21})} (v_2(t) - v_1(t)) \quad (4.88)$$

$$I_{h1}(t - \Delta t) = i_1(t - \Delta t) + \left(\frac{L_{22} \Delta t}{2(L_{11}L_{22} - L_{12}L_{21})} - \frac{L_{21} \Delta t}{2(L_{11}L_{22} - L_{12}L_{21})} \right) v_1(t - \Delta t) + \frac{L_{21} \Delta t}{2(L_{11}L_{22} - L_{12}L_{21})} (v_1(t - \Delta t) - v_2(t - \Delta t)) \quad (4.89)$$

$$\begin{aligned}
I_{h2}(t - \Delta t) = i_2(t - \Delta t) + & \left(\frac{L_{11} \Delta t}{2(L_{11}L_{22} - L_{12}L_{21})} - \frac{L_{21} \Delta t}{2(L_{11}L_{22} - L_{12}L_{21})} \right) v_1(t - \Delta t) \\
& + \frac{L_{12} \Delta t}{2(L_{11}L_{22} - L_{12}L_{21})} (v_2(t - \Delta t) - v_1(t - \Delta t))
\end{aligned} \tag{4.90}$$

As seen, formulas for the equivalent current injections can be derived from the equations above and are similar to those used for the lines. Some differences between lines and transformers can be highlighted. On the one hand, the currents and history components are calculated with different formulas. On the other hand, the history component in transformers delay only in one time-step, while in lines, the delay is τ depending on the characteristics of each line.

In order to add transformers to the system to be simulated, those are added as lines with different bus voltages at the two ends.

Following the ideal transformer assumption an uncoupled model is assumed for the three-phase transformer. Therefore, the three phases are modelled independently without mutual coupling between them and the matrix G_c is diagonal.

4.4 Implementation

The implementation of the EMT simulator in VeraGrid involves several steps, including the development of the core simulation engine, the integration with existing models, and the creation of user interfaces for configuration and result visualization. Regarding this project scope, the focus has been placed on the core simulation engine development and device models, and its integration with the existing dynamic framework. The GUI implementation, then, stays out of scope of this project and awaits as future work to be done.

4.5 Core simulation development: EMTP combined with the Symbolic-Numeric approach

The EMT simulation engine is developed in Python, following the general structure of the dynamic simulation framework in VeraGrid. The general simulation structure for any simulation in VeraGrid is shown in Figure 3.2 and widely explained in the subsection 3.2.2.

The main class responsible for the EMT simulation is the Driver class, which contains the simulation function itself. This function initializes the system, sets up the time-stepping loop, and performs the numerical integration using the EMTP method combined with the Symbolic-Numeric approach. The core of the simulation consists on solving the MNA equations at each time-step using the EMTP method. The aforementioned equation system, also found below is solved.

$$[G] [v(t)] = [i(t)] - [I_{\text{hist}}] \quad (4.91)$$

The current contributions are computed at each time-step based on the previous steps results and the device models. Due to the large variety of models for some devices while some others are standardized, a combined full numeric (traditional EMTP) and Symbolic-Numeric approach is used in the simulation. This means that some devices such as lines and transformers are modelled using standardized companion models explained in the previous subsection, while others such as generators are modelled using symbolic equations allowing the user to define custom models and parameters. This combination provides both flexibility and efficiency in the simulation.

In the context of this thesis, the generator model used is the EMT-type model synchronous machine explained in the previous subsection.

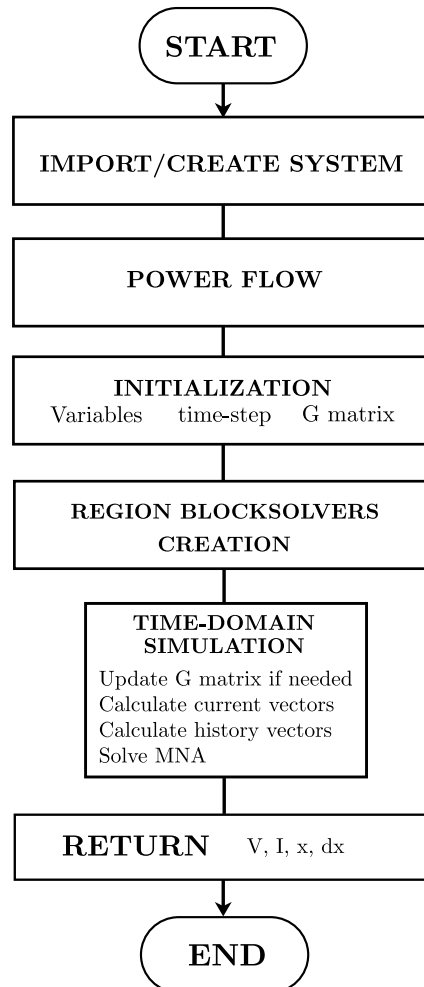


Figure 4.12: EMT simulation block diagram.

The operations done during an EMT simulation are summarized in Figure 4.13 and widely

explained in the following lines.

- *Initialization:* The system is initialized following the next steps:
 - *Time step adaptation based on the line parameters:* the time-step of the simulation must be a divisor of the largest line delay (τ). The time-step given by the user is then adapted to fulfill this requirement. Moreover, if it is too big, a message logger is raised to inform the user.
 - *Initial guess calculation:* If Symbolic-Numeric models are used, an initial guess of the state variables is needed to start the Newton-Raphson iterations. The bus voltages are obtained from the power flow solution, while the rest are obtained from initialization equations defined by each device model. The derivatives of the state variables are all set to 0.0.
 - *Initial conductance matrix G assembly:* The conductance matrix G is assembled by adding the contributions of all the devices in the system. The local G matrix for each device is computed when each device is initialized. In the case of the branches, a mask system is used to assemble the global G matrix efficiently. It is to be noted that the solver allows any number of phases (including neutral) to each bus. Therefore, the size of the G matrix is conditioned to the number of phases of each bus.
- *Region Symbolic-Numeric BlockSolvers creation:* To improve the efficiency of the simulation, the system is divided into regions based on the connectivity of Symbolic-Numeric models to each bus. Each bus has its own region composed by all the injections with Symbolic-Numeric models connected to it. Then, a BlockSolver is created for each region, which will be used to solve the local equations of the region during the time-stepping loop. In this way, the size of each system block to be solved is reduced and the calculation could be parallelized in future implementations to improve calculation time. A new class called "EMTSolverProperties" is created to store the Blocksolver, parameters, initial guesses and solutions of each region.
- *G matrix factorization:* The conductance matrix G is factorized using an LU decomposition to prepare it for the time-stepping loop.
- *Time-stepping loop:* For each time-step, the following operations are performed to simulate the system dynamics:
 - *Update Sources:* The current sources contributions from the Symbolic-Numeric models are calculated based on the previous step voltage solution. One time-step simulation is performed for each region using the BlockSolver created during initialization. Afterwards, the current contributions found in the simulations are assembled into

the global current source vector.

- *Update history currents:* The line and transformer history currents are updated based on the previous voltage and current solutions. It must be highlighted that in the case of the line, the history terms are updated only after the delay time has passed for each line. In the case of the transformers, the history components are updated at each time-step regarding the previous step results.
- *Solve MNA equations:* The MNA equation system is solved using the factorized G matrix and the updated current and history contributions.
- *Calculate branch currents:* The currents through each branch are calculated based on the updated voltages. Those are needed in future timesteps.

Figure 4.13 shows the block diagram of the EMT simulation process.

- *Results saving and post-processing:* After the simulation, results are saved in csv files and post-processed for analysis and visualization.

4.6 Benchmark and validation

TO DO

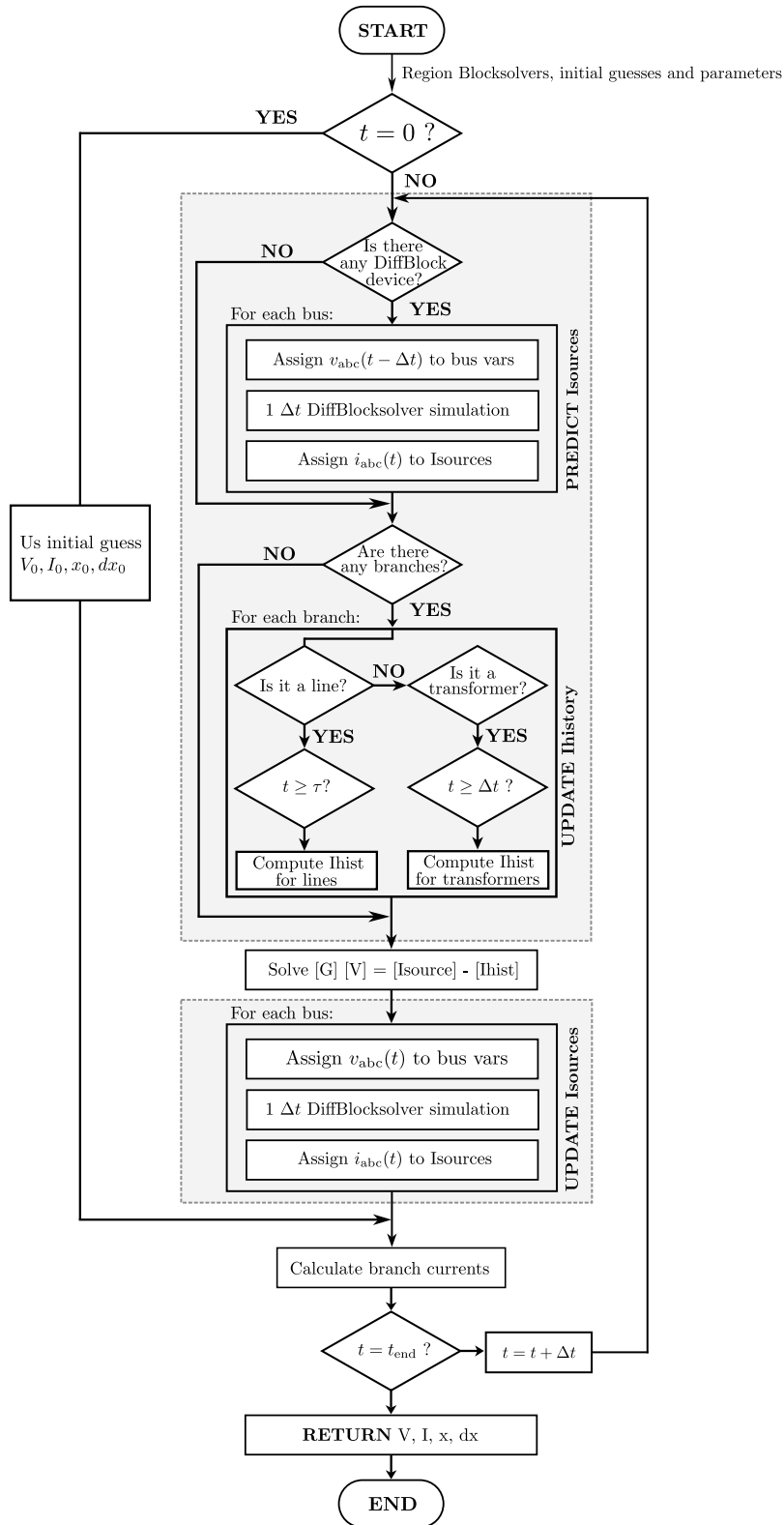


Figure 4.13: EMT simulation block diagram.

5 Environmental impact

An environmental contribution of this work lies in its support for energy efficiency and the ongoing energy transition. The developed framework contributes to the optimal operation and planning of power systems with high shares of renewable generation. Stability analysis allows network operators to safely integrate variable renewable sources such as wind and solar while maintaining system reliability. This, in turn, facilitates higher utilization of clean energy resources and reduces curtailment, leading to a more efficient use of installed capacity and a measurable reduction in carbon emissions. In a broader context, the development of robust and open simulation tools is essential to achieving global decarbonisation objectives and ensuring a stable, sustainable transition towards a low-carbon energy system [11].

Although the present work involves primarily computational and simulation tasks rather than physical infrastructure, it nonetheless carries meaningful environmental implications. Advanced RMS and EMT tools aid in the integration of renewable energy sources by improving the predictability and security of grid behavior, thereby helping reduce reliance on fossil fuel backup plants and associated greenhouse gas emissions[12]. The trade-off between simulation fidelity and computational cost is also well documented; for example, Yan et al. examine the impact of different numerical integration schemes on simulation accuracy and efficiency [13]. Minimizing computational energy consumption through algorithmic optimization is thus a relevant concern.

Moreover, the promotion of open-source platforms in power system research enhances resource efficiency by reducing duplicated development efforts and enabling community-driven innovation. The use of openly shared modeling libraries accelerates progress and lowers barriers to entry [14]. By providing validated simulation tools, this work contributes to more sustainable and cost-effective grid planning, potentially reducing the environmental footprint of energy infrastructure expansion.

On the other side, the actual footprint of the project development can be computed as kg of CO_2 equivalent emitted to the atmosphere. This study estimates the direct environmental footprint accounting for the electricity consumed by the computer and monitor, the corresponding share of HVAC energy use and the amortized embodied emissions of the electronic equipment. The calculation considers a five-month period (September to January), with a working schedule of eight hours per day, Monday to Friday. This corresponds to approximately $22 \text{ weeks} \cdot 5 \text{ days/week} \cdot 8 \text{ h/day} \approx 880 \text{ hours}$.

The working environment corresponds to a small office space in the center of Barcelona, shared by approximately 20 occupants. In order to simplify the study, the following assumptions are done:

- Only the energy used by the laptop and the monitor are considered.
- The kg of CO_2 equivalent emitted by the manufacturing and transportation of the laptop and monitor are considered. The office equipment is not considered.
- Only the energy consumption due to HVAC in the office is considered due to its high contribution to energy consumption in the office.

For the Laptop embodied emissions Circular Computing [15] proposes 331 kg CO_2 eq/device accounting for manufacturing, transport and 4 first years of use. According to their calculations, manufacturing and transport accounts by approximately 90% of those emissions. For the monitor, a standard monitor has been selected. HP sustainability report [16] states that 210 kg CO_2 eq/device are emitted during manufacturing, transport, use and end of life. Manufacturing, transport and end of life account for a 47% of those emissions. According to l'Institut Català de l'Energia (ICAEN) [17], the recommended average HVAC energy consumption in an office building is 140 kWh/m² year. Scaling this consumption to an average of 5 m² per person in a office and 260 working days a year the resulting energy consumption is 0,299 kWh/hour person. For the allocation factor of the laptop and monitor, 5 years of lifespan are assumed.

All parameters used are summarized in Table 5.1.

Table 5.1: Emission factors and embodied carbon data used in the estimation.

Source / Component	Value	Unit	Reference
Electricity emission factor (Spain, 2023)	0,26	kg CO_2 eq/kWh	[18]
Laptop embodied emissions (manufacturing)	297,9	kg CO_2 eq/device	[15]
Monitor embodied emissions (manufacturing)	94,47	kg CO_2 eq/device	[16]
Average laptop power draw	45	W	[19]
Average monitor power draw	37	W	[20]
HVAC energy use per occupant (shared office)	0,299	kWh/h pers	[17]
Allocation factor laptop and monitor	0.084	–	assumed

The total electricity consumption during the five-month period can be expressed as:

$$E_{total} = E_{PC+monitor} + E_{HVAC} \text{ [kWh]} \quad (5.1)$$

where:

$$E_{PC+monitor} = (P_L \text{ [W]} + P_M \text{ [W]}) \cdot \frac{880 \text{ h}}{1000 \text{ [W/kW]}} = 72,16 \text{ [kWh]} \quad (5.2)$$

$$E_{HVAC} = 0,299 \text{ kWh/h} \cdot 880 \text{ h} = 263,25 \text{ kWh} \quad (5.3)$$

Corresponding to a total of 87,206 kg of CO₂ eq due to energy consumption.

The allocation contribution of the LCA for the laptop and monitor correspond to a total of $(297,9 + 94,47) \text{ kg CO}_2 \text{ eq} \cdot 0,084 = 32,959 \text{ kg CO}_2 \text{ eq}$.

The total emissions are 120,165 kg of CO₂ eq. Table 5.2 summarizes the contribution of each element to the total

Table 5.2: Estimated carbon footprint of the thesis work including HVAC, lighting, and office equipment.

Component	kg CO ₂ eq emissions	Contribution
Laptop + monitor operation	18,761	15,613 %
HVAC energy consumption	68,444	56,958 %
Allocated embodied emissions (laptop + monitor)	32,959	27,428 %
Total estimated footprint	120,165	

Results conclude that the main contribution to the project development global emissions are due to the office HVAC being the 56,95% of the total equivalent CO₂ emissions. Regarding the laptop and monitor it is seen how the manufacturing and transporting contribution is much higher than the operation itself, highlighting the importance of Life Cycle Assessments on the environmental assessments.

To contextualize the estimated footprint of this work, it is useful to compare it with reference studies on greenhouse gas emissions in office environments. According to the European Environment Agency, the annual emissions associated with a standard office workplace in Europe (including HVAC, lighting, equipment, and commuting) are between 1500 and 2000 kg CO₂eq per employee [21]. The corresponding contribution of 5 months is between 625 and 833 kg CO₂ eq. As noted, in this study the EEA considers also the commuting to work. Circular Ecology [22] states that, in Europe, only 53% of the emissions of going to work in an office account for the office itself meaning 47% of the emissions correspond to commuting. Applying this percentage the average office emissions (including HVAC, lighting, equipment) in Europe are between 331,250 and 441,677 kg CO₂ eq.

In comparison, the total estimated footprint of approximately 120 kg CO₂eq for this thesis project is lower than the studies stated in the previous paragraph. It is to be considered that the EEA study considers both lightning and equipment while this study does not. Moreover, the average energy consumption in Europe is higher than in Spain so this result may be affected. Therefore, the result is considered correct and highlights the importance of energy-efficient habits.

6 Gender and social impact

The development of power system analysis tools is not only a technical activity but also one with clear social implications, particularly in the context of the ongoing energy transition. Modern electrical grids are critical infrastructures whose planning, operation, and regulation directly affect economic development, environmental sustainability, and social equity. As power systems evolve towards higher penetration levels of renewable and converter-based generation, the tools used to analyze stability and system behavior increasingly shape decision-making processes and, consequently, societal outcomes. For this reason, social and gender considerations are relevant even in technically focused research work.

The energy transition has been widely recognised as a multidimensional challenge that extends beyond technology deployment. According to the International Energy Agency (IEA), achieving long-term decarbonisation targets requires not only investment in renewable generation and grid infrastructure, but also a transformation of the workforce and the knowledge systems supporting energy planning and operation [23]. Engineering tools that enable secure and efficient integration of renewable energy sources contribute to system reliability and affordability, which are key elements of energy justice. In this sense, simulation frameworks such as the one developed in this work indirectly support broader societal goals by enabling informed technical decisions that reduce system risks and enhance the resilience of electricity networks.

Gender imbalance remains a structural issue in science, technology, engineering, and mathematics (STEM) fields, including power system engineering and software development. Multiple international studies show that women continue to be underrepresented in technical roles, particularly in areas related to electrical engineering, energy systems, and advanced software infrastructure [24, 25]. This imbalance limits diversity of perspectives in the design of technical tools and methodologies, potentially constraining innovation and reinforcing homogeneous problem-solving approaches. While this work does not directly address gender representation, it is developed within a sector where these structural challenges are present and should therefore be acknowledged.

Open-source software development constitutes a relevant mechanism for reducing some of the structural barriers associated with participation in technical fields. By providing unrestricted access to source code, documentation, and modelling methodologies, open-source platforms facilitate self-directed learning and enable contributions from a geographically and socially diverse community. This model lowers entry barriers related to licensing costs, institutional access, and proprietary knowledge, which disproportionately affect underrepresented groups. The European Commission has explicitly identified open science and open-source software as key enablers for inclusive innovation and equitable knowledge dissemination [26]. In this context, the open-source nature of VeraGrid contributes to a more accessible technical ecosystem.

From a social perspective, transparent and openly available simulation tools also enhance accountability and reproducibility in power system studies. Researchers, system operators, and students can independently verify assumptions, extend models, and adapt methodologies to local contexts. This openness supports capacity building in regions or institutions with limited access to commercial simulation tools, thereby contributing to a more equitable distribution of technical capabilities. Over time, such accessibility can support broader participation in energy system analysis and planning, which is particularly relevant in the context of rapidly evolving grids with high shares of renewable generation.

The social impact of advanced EMT simulation tools is also linked to their role in supporting reliable and secure electricity systems. Improved modelling of converter-dominated networks allows system operators and planners to anticipate stability issues, reduce the likelihood of large-scale disturbances, and design mitigation strategies. Reliable electricity supply is a prerequisite for social welfare, economic activity, and access to essential services. By contributing to the robustness of grid operation under high renewable penetration scenarios, this work indirectly supports societal resilience and the long-term sustainability of energy systems.

In a broader ethical context, engineers developing foundational simulation tools have a responsibility to consider the societal implications of their work. Promoting openness, transparency, and accessibility in technical development aligns with principles of responsible engineering and sustainable innovation. While open-source tools alone cannot resolve structural gender imbalances in STEM fields, they represent a necessary step towards more inclusive technical environments by reducing institutional and economic barriers. Future developments of the proposed framework could further enhance its social impact by incorporating educational resources, improving documentation accessibility, and encouraging contributions from a diverse user community.

Overall, this work contributes to the energy transition not only through its technical objectives but also by aligning with principles of inclusiveness, transparency, and social responsibility in engineering practice. By combining advanced simulation capabilities with an open-source development model, the proposed framework supports a more equitable and sustainable evolution of power system analysis tools.

7 Budget

This section provides an estimated budget for the development of the present master's thesis. While the work has been carried out as part of professional activity at eRoots Analytics, the following analysis reflects the costs that would reasonably be incurred if the project were to be considered as an engineering activity. The objective of this section is therefore to quantify the economic resources associated with the execution of the work, including labour, operational expenses, equipment usage, and other indirect costs.

The main cost associated with this project corresponds to the time devoted to its development. The work has been carried out during regular working hours, with a full-time dedication equivalent to eight hours per day during a total time of 22 weeks which is equivalent to 880 h. In line with the academic requirements of the Master's Thesis, the total workload is assumed to correspond to the standard number of credits associated with the TFE.

For the purpose of this estimation, an hourly cost of 15 €/h is assumed, as suggested in the project guidelines. The total effort is distributed among the main tasks defined in the project planning, including literature review, model development, implementation of RMS and EMT simulation tools, validation and testing, and report writing.

Table 7.1: Estimated labour cost

Task category	Estimated hours	Unit cost [€/h]	Cost [€]
Literature review and theoretical study	160	15	2400
Software development and implementation	400	15	6000
Simulation, testing and validation	200	15	3000
Documentation and thesis writing	120	15	1800
Total labour cost	880	–	13200

The execution of the project entails operational costs related to electricity consumption, HVAC usage, internet connectivity and general office resources. As the work was performed in a shared office environment with approximately 20 occupants, only the proportional share attributable to the thesis activity has been considered.

Office energy consumption values are derived from recommendations published by the Institut Català de l'Energia (ICAEN), which reports an average HVAC energy use of 140 kWh/m²·year for office buildings [17]. Additional reference values for office energy use and services are consistent with studies by the International Energy Agency and the European Environment Agency [21, 27].

Table 7.2: Estimated operational expenses

Concept	Estimated cost [€]
Electricity and HVAC (proportional share)	380
Internet and telecommunication services	120
Office consumables and miscellaneous expenses	100
Total operational expenses	600

The thesis was developed using company-owned electronic equipment, namely a work laptop and an external monitor. The technical characteristics and typical power consumption of these devices are consistent with commercially available mid-range equipment, such as the ASUS Vivobook series and standard AOC monitors [19, 20].

A linear amortisation model has been applied, assuming a useful life of five years for both devices. This assumption is consistent with common practice in life-cycle assessments and office energy studies [21, 28]. In line with the environmental impact assessment, an allocation factor of 0.084 has been used, corresponding to five months of use over a five-year lifespan.

Table 7.3: Equipment amortisation

Equipment	Purchase value [€]	Allocation factor	Allocated cost [€]
Laptop	1 800	0,084	151,2
External monitor	300	0,084	25,2
Total equipment amortisation	–	–	176,4

The project relies exclusively on numerical simulation and software development. All tools employed are either open-source or licensed by the hosting company, and no additional paid licenses, experimental services, or external data sources were required specifically for the execution of this work. As a result, no direct costs are allocated to software and external services.

Total estimated budget

Table 7.4 summarizes the total estimated cost of the project, combining labour, operational expenses and equipment amortization. This budget represents an approximation of the resources required to carry out the thesis in a professional engineering context.

Table 7.4: Total estimated project budget

Cost category	Cost [€]
Labour costs	13 200
Operational expenses	600
Equipment amortisation	176
Total estimated budget	13 976

8 Time Planning

Figure 8.1 shows the temporal evolution of the various tasks that have constituted the project.

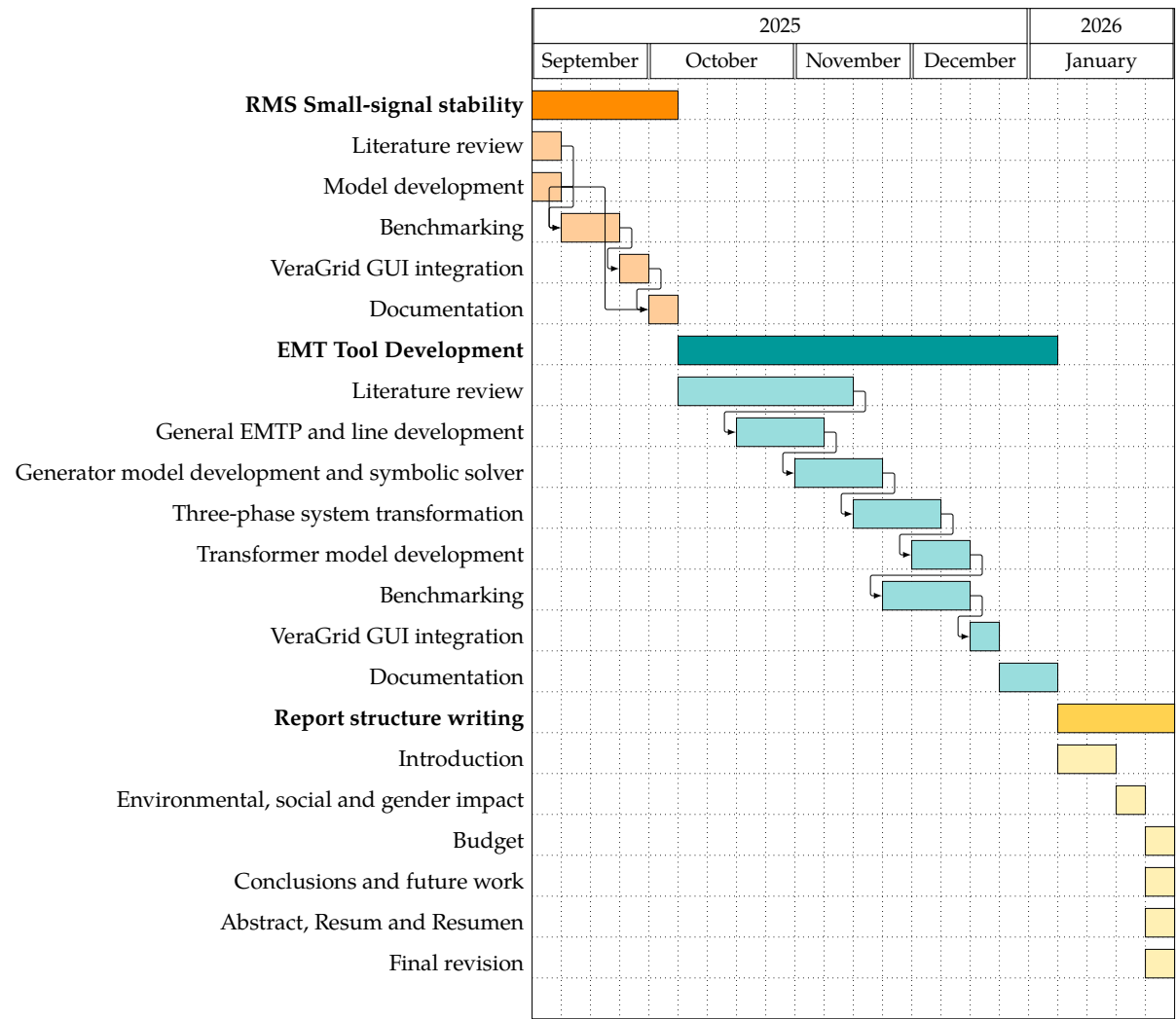


Figure 8.1: Gantt Chart of the project.

9 Conclusion

blablabla

9.1 Further Work

- Allow the EMT simulation to handle events on the grid.
- Implement parallelization of the region BlockSolvers to improve calculation time.
- Include more device models in the Symbolic-Numeric framework to increase the versatil-

ity of the EMT simulation.

- Create the GUI interface for the EMT simulation setup and results visualization.
- Perform extensive testing and validation of the EMT simulation with a variety of test systems and scenarios.
- Optimize the code for performance improvements, including memory management and computational efficiency.
- Change the line model to a frequency-dependent one to improve accuracy.
- Implement a more robust transformer model including saturation effects.
- Incorporate renewable energy source models, such as wind solar and converters, into the EMT simulation framework.

Acknowledgments

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